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DASTS Conference

29-30 June 2026

Encountering Infrastructures

DASTS Conference 2026: **Encountering Infrastructures**
Book of Abstracts

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CONFERENCE THEME

Encountering Infrastructures

Studying science, technology, and society through the lens of infrastructures is no doubt a well-established STS tradition. It has guided our attention to how we live with the things of the world. However, in times of crisis, change, hype, and hope new demands to encounter infrastructures arise. Infrastructures do not only bring smoothness, efficiency, and connectivity, they are also sites of environmental disaster, leakage, cyber-attacks, and violations of privacy and power. From debates around European digital sovereignty and the spread of AI to the fragile maintenance of institutions of knowledge and welfare states, there is a renewed urgency to infrastructures today.

With this conference, we invited participants to encounter infrastructures in new ways:

- What are the most intriguing contemporary cases of infrastructuring? How are infrastructures imagined, built, and sustained in different domains? What (in)visibilities, dependencies, controversies, and versions of 'the good' emerge from and with infrastructuring?
- How are infrastructures lived as ecological, affective, and more-than-human assemblages? How can artistic, speculative, and experimental methodologies energize and enrich STS studies of infrastructure?
- What insights can be drawn from moments in the life of infrastructures, such as renewal, updates, breakdowns, decommissioning, and ending? What can we learn from the many human or nonhuman actors who shape, experience, contest, or depend upon infrastructures in everyday life? How can STS scholars contribute to building better infrastructures?

KEYNOTE SPEAKER

Steven J. Jackson

Steven Jackson is a Professor of Information Science and Science and Technology Studies and Vice-Provost for Academic Innovation at Cornell University. He works on problems of technology ethics, law and policy along with governance and collaboration: the million and one ways in which people work together to produce better outcomes, big and small. He's especially interested in infrastructure, repair, and the pragmatics of hope, and the places where new computational practices meet shifting social and material worlds with implications for sustainability, justice and inequality. He also directs the Computing On Earth Lab, an experimental collaboration that brings together social scientists, humanists, artists and engineers to rethink the material and planetary foundations of computing.

1

Infrastructures of Terroir: Situated Worlds, Knowledge Frictions, and the Politics of Attachment

Adrien Rigobello (Royal Danish Academy), **Joshua David Evans** (Technical University of Denmark), **Kasper Ostrowski** (Aarhus University), **Martin Grünfeld** (University of Copenhagen)

In Science and Technology Studies, infrastructures have long been approached as relational achievements: heterogeneous assemblages of humans, nonhumans, institutions, standards, and imaginaries that make worlds durable while remaining largely invisible. In parallel, sociohistorical and ethnographic work on terroir, from food and craft to design, ecology, and knowledge practices, has developed a vocabulary for understanding how worlds are enacted through situated attachments, contested epistemologies, and materially grounded forms of care.

This panel proposes to encounter terroir as an infrastructural phenomenon and infrastructures as sites of terroirization. Rather than treating terroir as a bounded cultural heritage or romantic localism, we approach it as an ongoing infrastructural accomplishment: a dense ecology of legal dispositifs, scientific classifications, microbial life, sensory practices, educational institutions, peer cultures, communicative forms, and political struggles. From protected designations of origin and veterinary regimes to design practices, ecological pedagogy, and science communication, terroir emerges as a mode of world-making that both relies on and troubles dominant infrastructural logics of standardization, scalability, and epistemic distance. Bringing together STS, Actor–Network Theory, and infrastructural studies, the panel stages a dialogue around a shared problem: how terroir foregrounds tensions between universalizing infrastructures and situated ways of knowing, sensing, and governing worlds. It explores moments where infrastructures leak, resist, or are reworked through terroirized practices, whether in food systems, material cultures, ecological education, design, or knowledge circulation; Encounters which might generate epistemic dizziness: a productive disorientation that challenges modernist ideals of control, transparency, and communicability.

Aligned with DASTS 2026's call for new ways of encountering infrastructures, this panel foregrounds experimental methodologies, narrative forms, and collective inquiry. Rather than offering solutions, we seek to open a shared space for debate: What does it mean to infrastructure attachment, care, and ecological relations? And how might terroir help STS scholars imagine and contribute to more situated, ethical, and liveable infrastructures in times of ecological and political uncertainty.

1.1. Infrastructuring Agrobiodiversity Terroirs: Exploring Coordination Architectures in Restorative Farmland Conversion

Markus Wernli (The Hong Kong Polytechnic University)

This paper advances an STS-informed understanding in agrobiodiversity transitions—not primarily as technical optimisation problems, but as matters of coordination that (re)infrastructure terroirs. Using Danish farmland conversion under the Green Tripartite Agreement as an empirical locus, it contrasts universalising climate and biodiversity infrastructures – such as carbon accounting – with situated, contested ways of coinhabiting landscapes, rooted in multispecies attachments, agrarian histories, and community initiatives. The paper introduces 'coordination interfaces' as key analytic sites where farmers, authorities, consultants, and land care collectives negotiate restoration, and where terroirs are actively made and unmade. It operationalises four interdependent variables –competence distribution, reciprocity formats, institutional embedding, and conflict mediation capacity – to examine how restoration durability emerges as a sociotechnical achievement under conditions of epistemic ambiguity and friction. Infrastructuring attachment is treated as a central (typically invisible) dimension of environmental governance, involving nonhuman relations and unevenly distributed labour. The paper concludes by proposing these variables as portable questions for analysing other infrastructural terroirs and argues for liveable infrastructures that respect situated knowledges, cultivate plural attachments, and re-compose ecologies of participation in agrobiodiversity transitions.

1.2. Scaling Infrastructures of Roquefort Cheese

Kasper Ostrowski (Aarhus University)

This presentation engages with what might be termed a "traditional" terroir-oriented investigation into food and transforming foodscapes, with particular attention to shifting regimes of geographical identification and designation. Geographical Indications (GIs) conventionally rely on notions of sameness and demarcation, stabilizing links between product, place, practice and 'ethereality'. However, processes of scaling such designations foreground their ontological instability, revealing how enactments of sameness and demarcation are continuously reconfigured across spatial and institutional registers. The French cheese Roquefort-sur-Soulzon is the oldest protected GI cheese, regulated since 1411 and officially under AOC/PDO status since 1925. Focusing on the infrastructural trajectory of Roquefort, the analysis approaches terroir through the lens of provisioning - ongoing practices of growth, propagation, and maintenance. It traces how delimitation, (re)classification, and bordering practices produce sameness and difference while enrolling heterogeneous actors including regulatory bodies, maps, sheep, fungi, and specific topographies. By tracing the infrastructural lineage of the celebrated and historic Roquefort cheese, this presentation demonstrates how the imperative to increase production is combatted in a complex human-non-human arena, where terroir emerges through changing enactments of sameness and demarcation.

1.3. Fragility as a Knoweldge Paradigm for Design in Urban Terroir

Giuliano Galluccio, Mariia Nanusheva (University of Naples Federico II)

The paper reflects on the concept of fragility as an opportunity for situated design practices in marginal contexts of the built environment. In particular, the study investigates fragility as a bottom-up way of knowing in opposition to top-down methodologies. If the latter are based on the recognition of patterns, normalization and modeling to inform decision-making processes with understandable data, the first is based on contested observations, subjective viewpoints, micro-narrations, outlining latent tensions and negotiations potentials between objects, human and non-human actors within their eco-socio-technical milieu. In this sense, a fragility-based design approach might be crucial, especially in conditions of informational uncertainty or urban fragmentation. The work experiments a case study in Quartieri Spagnoli in Naples (IT), a peripherical area of the historical center of the city, to explore a methodology to help designers and decision-makers to take into account elements that are usually ignored or underestimated in data-driven approaches, through their recognition as elements of environmental devices, i.e. infrastructures of relationships between objects, subjects and their context. This recognition is crucial to help designers to reinterpret urban design processes as acts of "taking care", aimed at support local actors in the transformation of their contexts accordingly with ecological capacities, social aspirations and technological dispositions.

1.4. Counter-Valuing Food Futures: Resistance to Cultivated Meat and the Politics of FoodTech Innovation

Tanja Schneider (Technical University of Denmark)

This paper examines resistance to FoodTech as a site of counter-valuation, where the future of food innovation is actively negotiated. Focusing on Italy's ban on cultivated meat, it situates this case within broader transnational patterns in Europe and North America, where FoodTech initiatives encounter diverse forms of pushback. Resistance, here, is not mere rejection but an active process reasserting which foods, knowledge, and futures should be sustained. Through a document analysis, the paper treats regulatory frameworks, policy submissions, NGO reports, and legal documents as valuation devices that qualify, dispute, and reassemble sustainability claims. The analysis reveals how laws, labeling disputes, and heritage claims enact distinct valuations of food innovation, exposing tensions between market efficiency, ecological responsibility, and cultural authenticity. It demonstrates how diverse actors assemble counter-valuations, reshaping who defines innovation and which futures gain traction. By foregrounding the valuation work embedded in and beyond innovation infrastructures, this paper contributes to and expands STS research on the critical engagement with the politics of sustainable food innovation.

1.5. Acoustic Terroirs: Embodied Multispecies Listening as an Infrastructural Challenge

Martin Grünfeld (University of Copenhagen)

In this talk, I examine how terroir can reconfigure knowledge infrastructures in science communication. I explore how communicative practices can emerge from—and interfere with—the environments in which they take shape, asking what it might mean to terroir-ize science communication. This exploration develops through a retrospective deconstruction of The Toad Band, a series of sound-based, performative workshops held in the Copenhagen Zoo in 2025. Featuring the threatened European green toad population living in the Northern Harbour Landfill, the workshops sought to redirect attention from distant charismatic species toward local, mundane ecologies. Sound functioned as a medium for evoking the toads' acoustic habitat, mobilizing ecoacoustic cues and cultivating embodied modes of listening and response-ability. Across three examples, I show how our terroir-like experiences of the landfill—its spatial textures, multispecies relations and anthropogenic traces—shaped the workshops. At the same time, transposing these encounters into the institutional setting of the Zoo generated frictions, revealing how terroir-ized science communication can unsettle—and be unsettled by—existing knowledge infrastructures. Treating terroir as a critical reflexive frame invites us to listen to how place and multispecies encounters reverberate through communicative infrastructures, revealing the aesthetic, ecological and institutional forces that shape what counts as knowledge and how it can be felt.

1.6. Reframing Rot Within Architectural Practice and Discourse – From Threat to Metabolic Infrastructure

Phil Ayres (Royal Danish Academy)

Within orthodox architectural discourse and construction practice, rot has been perpetually framed as a threat to material durability, stability and symbolic ideals of permanence. In contrast, ecological perspectives understand rot as critical infrastructure within regenerative processes - unbuilding organic matter through local, situated decomposition and aiding the redistribution of constituents to drive new constructive potentials.

The advent of mycelium-based materials within the built environment is underpinned by the use of saprotrophic fungi - species of rot that play a cornerstone role in ecology. Embracing these species as co-producers of material for architecture demands a theoretical and practical reframing of rot within architecture. At the very least, this should establish a more nuanced perspective to account for new relations with rot as infrastructure rather than a mode of failure. More ambitiously, could a reframing of rot as metabolic infrastructure for architecture lead to terroir focused design approaches, spatial proposition & courses of action that could transform the built environment from ecological burden to ecological asset?

This position underpins recent investigations at the Chair for Biohybrid Architecture which seek to foreground architecture as a continuously negotiated ecological interface and is examined in the installation 'Architecture Must Rot – Gaiarama 1.0', exhibited within the show FUNGI – Anarchist Designers.

1.7. Changing Infrastructures: Preserving Endangered Terroirs through Wild Fermentation

Agnieszka Pokrywka (Aalto University)

Food fermentation is often described as an expression of terroir: from region-specific wines to site-specific cheeses. Likewise, the wild fermentation of plants foraged from forests or parks can also be an expression of terroir, as it is shaped by local microbial ecologies. However, what happens when these sites are clear-cut or urbanized? Redevelopment projects may include measures to protect or relocate rare plant and animal species, yet they largely overlook the microbial communities that also constitute these ecologies. How could we document and preserve the microbial assemblages associated with a site when its material and infrastructural form is redesigned? In this proposal, I outline a method and case study based on collecting fermentation starters from sites that are about to be destroyed, cultivating and preserving them not as static taxa but as living ecosystems. Through artistic research, I reflect on what is actually being preserved when an "endangered terroir" is addressed through food fermentation. I speculate on whether fermentation can function as a technique for preserving terroir microbiomes and their evolving relationship with humans. This proposal foregrounds narrative, speculative, hands-on and sensory practices to investigate how attachments to wild microbial communities and their terroirs might persist and be cared for within standardized urban infrastructures.

1.8. Divergent Paths to Plant-Based Futures of Food: Reshaping Agri-Food Regimes Between Care for Earth, Animals, Soil and Community

Marie Leth (University of Gothenburg)

With climate change and growing pressure on nutrient-rich agricultural land, land use has become inseparable from food system transformation in the Global North. Drawing on the notion of foodscapes, this paper explores the promise of more terrestrial approaches to reshaping dominant diets and production regimes. It centers on the emergence of "plant-based" as both a conceptual container for imagining alternative food futures and a basis for policy and innovation in the food sector. Plant-based food foregrounds the need for large-scale land transformation, given the extensive land demands of meat-based diets, while also opening possibilities for rethinking interspecies relations grounded in ethics of care promoting animal welfare, soil health and food sovereignty. Tracing key policies and visions advanced by civil society and policy actors, the paper examines how plant-based imaginaries oscillate between dominant paradigms and more situated approaches. These function both as radical visions and as projects that must engage existing infrastructures. Situating these dynamics within the socio-historical evolution of animal-centered agri-food systems, the paper traces how plant-based visions are negotiated and adapted as they move across divergent domains of knowledge, ethics, practice and policy.

1.9. (Infra)structured Partnerships - The Case of the Indo-Danish Green Strategic Partnership

Frederikke Bencke (University of Copenhagen)

The field of diplomacy and private-public cooperation has always been extremely code-ified, traversed by deep explicit and implicit notions of protocol and gate-keeping — both symbolic and ritualistic. Culturally, temporarily and geographically situated, these are informed by colonial notions of progress and "development", as well as the inherent market logics of late stage capitalism and neoliberalism. My research focuses on the Green Strategic Partnership between India and Denmark, and its central-stage water-sector collaboration component. Drawing on recent multi-sited ethnographic fieldwork in India and Denmark, I approach the partnership as one that (infra)structures bureaucratic processes by selling a "promissory approach" to public-private partnerships. As such, the field of diplomatic cooperation could be seen as a literal and figurative maze of infrastructures, both physical and implicit, where diplomats (re)produce and commodify discourses as precursors to capital investment. Diplomats are the functionaries of statecraft, yet their true praxis remains veiled in cocktail parties and official discourse. This research asks where this infrastructure begins and ends, and how situated encounters reify some of its edges while obscuring others. Engaging the dialectical relationship of (infra)structures, it positions diplomacy as both object and method, showing how infrastructures of cooperation delimit what can be known about their own political economy.

2

Software as Soft Power? Recompositions in and of the Digital State

Irina Papazu (IT University Copenhagen), **Christopher Gad** (IT University Copenhagen), **Alexei Tsinovoi** (Aarhus University)

Has the soft power of software become hard? This panel explores ambiguous power relations in digital statecraft: dependencies on tech providers, alternative forms of public sector digitalization, transnational collaboration, and how digital infrastructures reshape state-citizen relations.

Digital transformation initiatives have long promised states enhanced efficiency, openness, and citizen engagement. But in the pursuit of these goals, state relations to tech companies, citizens, and territory have shifted significantly. We are increasingly puzzled by power in processes like Microsoft's and AWS' evolving role in government operations, the rollout of digital ID systems, inter-state sharing of 'digital solutions'; and digital (re-)compositions of spaces and territories. A clear distinction between power as 'soft' (e.g. working towards building international reputation and national identity, promoting investment and exports), and 'hard' (e.g. leveraging or contesting control over infrastructure in military and economic conflict) seems harder to draw, warranting new conversations on power in digital statecraft.

In this panel, we explore the inner workings of digitally transforming states in moments of breakdown, transition, resistance, or unexpected inversion, as well as how these transformations reshape state-citizen encounters.

We examine research related to:

- Overflowing boundaries and intensified questions of control and expertise between state actors and tech providers
- How states adopt, adapt, or resist digital solutions from other sites
- Moments when dependencies and lock-ins are revealed
- Configurations of digital statecraft that recompose state and citizen agency
- Alternative forms of public sector digitalization

2.1. When Open Data Stop Being Open

Dina Friis Toft (Aarhus University)

This paper investigates the trajectories of open government data in the context of Danish municipalities responsible for distributing the costs of coastal protection. Municipalities levy contributions from those who benefit from protection measures, making the definition of beneficiaries, and the territories they inhabit, a complex data-driven task. Drawing on interviews with municipalities and private data providers, I examine how open government data circulate and how this influences the kind of territories that can be enacted. I develop three arguments. First, data change through circulation. Although datasets originate as authoritative public registers, their meaning and function shift as they are aggregated, visualized, and mobilized within new decision-making contexts. Second, this circulation reshapes governance roles. Private companies increasingly act as intermediaries that curate, model, and interpret public data for municipalities, thereby entering the coastal governance ecosystem in an empowered position. Third, open data may become proprietary in practice. While originally released as freely accessible government data, they are reassembled into proprietary analytical tools and services that municipalities must purchase in order to operationalize them. I wish to contribute to debates on data governance by showing how open data infrastructures generate new political economies, accountability relations, and territorial enactments.

2.2. From Digitalized Care to Mobilization: Shifting Logics of Government Portals in Situations of Crisis

Irina Papazu (IT University Copenhagen) **& Alexei Tsinovoi** (Aarhus University)

As illustrated by the Covid-19 pandemic, situations of emergency and crisis can catalyze and accelerate public digitalization efforts, changing not only their pace but the logics embedded in them. In this paper we examine how situations of crisis generated by international conflicts, characterized by strong discourses of national security and threats of physical harm to the population, affect the logics and practices that govern public sector digitalization. We do so by focusing on national government portals. Digital portals for government information and services are often considered a prime site for digitalization efforts; a type of 'front door' to the state (Henman et al 2021) designed to 'make interaction with citizens smoother, easier, and more efficient' (Laybe and Lee 2001, 123), thus expressing a logic of welfarist, pastoral care. By studying two such portals – Ukraine's diia.gov.ua and Israel's gov.il – we examine how in situations of crisis the otherwise predominant logic of welfarist care embedded in these types of initiatives may be supplemented, or even replaced, by a new logic of instrumental mobilization, which enacts the population not as objects in need of care but as resources that can be mobilized by the state, thus illustrating how the same digital affordances that enable the state to provide care for the population can be repurposed to mobilize citizen participation in state-led initiatives aimed to address the crisis.

2.3. The Everyday Politics of Algorithmic Warfare: Experiences and Imaginaries of Generative Artificial Intelligence in the Danish Army

Daniel Møller Ølgaard (Royal Danish Defence College)

Artificial Intelligence-enabled technologies are generally assumed to have a pivotal role to play in future warfare. In the last decade or so, political leaders, military decision-makers and industry representatives have publicly imagined how emerging AI technologies will disrupt and revolutionize military affairs for better or worse. Adding to these discussions, this article explores the voices of a group of actors that have so far received little attention in high-level debates on algorithmic warfare: The military commanders tasked with integrating new AI technologies into military practices. Combining field observations and questionnaire data, it studies the emerging and experimental use of a particular AI technology – so-called Large Language Models (LLMs) sometimes also referred to as generative AI (GenAI) – across two mission planning courses at the Royal Danish Military Academy. Based on this, the paper explores how Danish army officers make sense of, utilize, and anticipate the possibilities and challenges associated with the use of LLMs in warfare, far from government offices, corporate boardrooms and military headquarters. Exploring and understanding these seemingly mundane imaginaries and experiences, as the paper further demonstrates, is a necessary but overlooked resource for fostering responsible ways of using AI for military purposes.

2.4. Digital Pastoral Care in the the Evangelic-Lutheran Church in Denmark, an Alternative Form of Digitalization

Christopher Gad (IT University Copenhagen)

As an organization, The Evangelic-Lutheran Church in Denmark (ELCD) is a hybrid form. The church and its employees operate at the intersection between 'administration' and 'faith' (Aggerbeck et.al 2023). The ELCD, of which 75% of the Danish population are members, commonly known as the 'folk church', is both a church and a secular state bureaucracy, managing, e.g. the Danish name registry. The latest Danish government foundation document expressed the hope that the church will play a central role as a culture bearing institution in saving Denmark from a perceived crisis of trust and community.

Digitalization of the public sector in Denmark has been profound which arguably is connected to this crisis. But the church has been somewhat resistant to digitalization, partly because power is not centralized and neo-liberal arguments of optimization sometimes are directly at odds with religious purposes. In the church lively debates are ongoing about whether and how specific digital technologies afford and affect church activities.

In this presentation I will present and discuss som observations from my investigation of digital pastoral care, as and example of an alternative form of digitalization project and 'care' service emerging in the church context, with implications for how we might talk about presence, community and care in a digital world

2.5. Europe and the Digital World of Tomorrow

Jesper Balslev, Morten Rold, Peter Tholstrup & Troels Ringsted
(Business Academy Copenhagen)

In Europe "digital sovereignty" has taken centre stage since President Trumps challenge of classical political alliances. Political organs argue for moving from US big tech towards European alternatives (Euractiv, 2026) (Dansk Industri, 2026) (Danmark Skifter, 2026). It is a paradigm shift within digital discourse in policy, from the notion of "the digital" as a global phenomenon, towards something that should be patrolled at the border, homegrown or regulated. How does Europe imagine doing this? Is it possible to embed European values as the uncompromising "standard" in new innovations? By what measures would 'the good' or 'better' be defined? Rebuild.net is an initiative by former EU-commissary Margrethe Vestager and entrepreneur Thomas Mygdal, that gathers companies to propose alternatives. From the website: "The Rebuild journey is 12 months to support the new generation of social platforms. Through gatherings, programmes, and tools". As a phenomenon, Rebuild is an assemblage of policy, entrepreneurship, a cultural movement, and a reaction to US big tech. It is also a field populated with technological actors that shape perceptions of sovereignty.

We aim to map specific values within the Rebuild movement, identify classification boundaries, trace negotiations about who earns a position in their directory, find out where sovereignty-thresholds clash, analyse value conflicts at decision points, finally: attend to embodied experiences.

3

The Interpretive Layer: Expertise as Infrastructure in Sociotechnical Systems

Matt Artz (Aalborg University), **Lora Koycheva** (Brandenburg Technical University)

Contemporary sociotechnical systems rely not only on code and components, but on a variety of forms of expertise that enable systems to function across cultural, organizational, and contextual differences. This panel examines how disciplinary knowledge—cultural reasoning, contextual judgment, domain interpretation—becomes an infrastructural layer within both computational and physical systems. How are they embedded into design decisions, operational protocols, interfaces, and standards? How do they make or break the ways cyber-physical systems take residence in the world outside of their lab testing sandboxes?

Extending Star's insights on infrastructure to knowledge-intensive systems, we are calling for various explorations of expertise-as-infrastructure. Is it distinct from purely material or technical substrates? Is it integrative of them, and how? Under what conditions does it become salient? What do notions and practices of care, maintenance, imagination, and improvisation play in the ways cyber-physical systems take form and a life on their own? These dynamics span software and hardware alike: from AI systems that fail at cultural complexity, to medical devices misaligned with clinical practice, to sensor networks that misinterpret environments, users, or bodies. When systems break down—through mistranslation, unsafe automation, misclassification, inappropriate affordances, or operational failure across contexts—these moments often reveal absent or eroded interpretive infrastructure. Yet responsibility is frequently attributed to "the technology," obscuring the missing disciplinary, experiential, or contextual substrate that made the system brittle in the first place.

This produces a persistent paradox: when expertise is successfully infrastructured, it becomes invisible, undermining the institutional conditions needed for its own maintenance and renewal. Disciplines and knowledge communities whose insights are embedded into technical systems—whether software models, hardware standards, design practices, or operational workflows—may find themselves extracted from, uncredited, and defunded, becoming casualties of their own effectiveness.

3.1. The Labor of Staying Relevant at the AI Frontier

Abdullah Omran (Indiana University Bloomington)

Most studies of expertise-as-infrastructure focus on systems rather than people. The interviews here take the other direction. Faculty, postdocs, and PhD students in a robotics lab and a quantum natural language processing lab at Indiana University Bloomington describe how they imagine their futures in relation to the systems they help build. The question matters because both labs do the kind of work that has, historically, ended disciplines: translating specialised knowledge into models, datasets, and libraries that should eventually run without their authors. The researchers describe this in quite practical terms. Some hope a motion-planning stack will "outlive the PhD." Others expect a grammar formalism will be "fixed" once it enters a toolkit, or assume that later users will never see the elicitation work behind benchmark data. Some read this as the normal fate of successful research. Others are less certain. They worry about what it means for the disciplines that trained them when their contribution persists as infrastructure but their role does not. How researchers talk about staying in academia, moving into industry, or leaving the field is not incidental to how they build interpretive expertise into AI systems. It is part of the mechanism. The prospect of doing work that may close the institutional space for one's own kind of expertise is already shaping how people plan, and following those plans is one way to see infrastructuring before it is complete.

3.2. On Infrastructuring Technological Infrastructures, or How to Control Technological Environments with Puppet(s).

Sol Martinez Demarco (Harz University of Applied Sciences)

In any organisation hardware and software need to be provisioned, configured, deployed, maintained and repaired, but there is hardly any focus on the ones who carry out these tasks. Invisible to many, system administrators, site reliability engineers and DevOps are the missing players bridging the gaps between technical infrastructure and public facing digital services. Configuration management applications are one among the many tools they rely on for their work. This contribution draws on a case study of an open-source community developing one such platform, OpenVox. This configuration management system is a fork of Puppet, in turn a tool that played a strategic role since its inception in 2005 in turning tacit knowledge and not-longer valid bash scripts into a reliable instrument for setting up cloud infrastructures. The community, VoxPupuli, whose members include many long-term users and developers of Puppet – and now of OpenVox, organises itself and shares members' work, knowledge and expertise through several channels (GitHub, Slack, IRC, and mailing lists). Based on ethnographic observations, documentary analysis and semi-structured interviews with members of the community I provide my first impressions on how the awareness of their knowledge, skills, expertise and shared values led to a successful fork and the maintenance of infrastructure for institutions such as CERN.

3.3. Expertise as Infrastructure: When Anthropological Knowledge Animates AI and Vanishes into the Substrate

Matt Artz (Aalborg University)

Disciplinary knowledge is becoming the operative substrate of AI. From prompt-encoded skills to MCP servers to neuro-symbolic architectures, formalizing expertise is reshaping what these systems can do and whose knowledge they depend on. This paper draws on two cases to examine what becomes possible when anthropological knowledge is formalized, and what vanishes.

The first case, the AI Anthropology Toolkit, encodes craft knowledge into skills, MCP servers, and a Claude plugin — expertise that shapes what the system attends to and how it reasons, but remains invisible to the researchers it serves. The second case, the SfAA Bibliographic Graph, formalizes 84 years of applied anthropology scholarship as a knowledge graph integrated with an LLM. The knowledge is structured as data: queryable, operational, and equally invisible.

Together these cases show that anthropology has the knowledge and skills to build AI infrastructure that matters. Yet in both, two layers of labor vanish: the accumulated work of scholars whose knowledge the systems draw on, and the work of making it machine-readable. The same tools that extend disciplinary capability erode disciplinary distinctiveness the moment they circulate — and the more successfully anthropological expertise is embedded, the more it animates systems that no longer need anthropologists. This paper asks whether we might become casualties of our own computational effectiveness, and how we might design to remain visible.

3.4. Infrastructuring Contingency: A Praxiography of Humanities Research Data Infrastructures

Fabian Pittroff (Ruhr University Bochum)

Research data infrastructures are gaining ground in the German academic landscape. National projects are consolidating, and universities are establishing permanent advisory bodies. Based on multi-year praxiographic fieldwork, this contribution reports from one of the target recipients of these efforts – a humanities research center, in part sceptical toward this development. There appears to be a mismatch between humanities research practices and the infrastructures developed. To better understand this mismatch and explore ways to mediate it, the contribution starts from the observation that, while data management policies ask for systematic and stable data use, humanities research aims for a non-positivist exploration of contingency – treating its materials not as fixed, but as occasions for interpretation that remain open-ended. At the same time, fieldwork on the infrastructural ecology documents numerous everyday, often personal, data practices. Drawing on these observations and combining them with social theories of data, the contribution offers a broader understanding of data, that can trace the multiple, sometimes neglected, roles research data infrastructures play in everyday humanities work. The contribution concludes with insights from an attempt to incorporate technical and non-technical components into an existing infrastructural ecology, better aligning it with humanities data practices by embracing contingency.

3.5. Steps to Green AI Commons: Towards an Infrastructural Turn For An Environmentally Responsible Machine

Lora Koycheva (Brandenburg Technical University)

As artificial intelligence (AI) systems scale across domains, their operation increasingly depends on vast, energy-intensive infrastructures whose environmental and epistemic conditions remain largely invisible to end users. This results in everyday use of AI, which heavily leans towards the trivial – from preferring AI mode in simple searches to producing waltzing cat videos. At the same time, Ethical and Responsible AI (RAI) frameworks have proliferated across institutional contexts, seeking to guide the development and deployment of these systems. Yet these frameworks overwhelmingly center human-facing concerns such as bias, fairness, and transparency, while the environmental and infrastructural substrates that sustain AI, such as water consumption and energy use, remain marginal to their normative scope.

3.6. When Infrastructure Decides Who Can Innovate: Platform Dependency and the Politics of Startup Scaling in Global South Ecosystems

Priyanka Dass Saharia (Independent Researcher)

Science and Technology Studies (STS) have long examined infrastructure as sociotechnical systems that organise everyday life. Contemporary innovation ecosystems increasingly rely on platform infrastructures like cloud computing environments and compliance frameworks that can shape who can build technological systems and under what conditions. While often framed as neutral enablers of entrepreneurship, these infrastructures can function as gatekeeping mechanisms in early stage venture formations. This paper draws on ethnographic field notes from mentorship sessions with the founder of a Johannesburg based, early stage health technology startup developing an AI-enabled healthcare analytics platform for clinical data management and decision support. The case traces how founders navigate infrastructural requirements like cloud deployment, data security, regulatory compliance. For the founder, cloud infrastructure is a prerequisite for building the product, ' we have lots of APIs, automations, security needs...AWS helps us jump those loops because they can already handle the compliance.' The analysis shows how negotiating platform infrastructure distributes labour and risks onto founders. By foregrounding these moments of infrastructural friction, the paper argues that Global South startup ecosystems are not merely sites of technological adoption but situated environments of knowledge production, where innovation emerges through ongoing negotiation with infrastructural power.

3.7. Expertise as a Vector of Power Embedded by Attention in 'transformative' and 'decentralised' Socio-technical Agglomerations

Joshua Quade Rose (University of Melbourne)

Cryptocurrencies are socio-technical agglomerations that are presented by proponents as instruments of social transformation. The perceived potential for social transformation relies on expert interpretations of cryptocurrency's value. I argue competing interpretations produce a struggle for attention within and across fragments of the cryptocurrency community. Drawing from over three years of participant observation, interviews and digital ethnographic research with Melbourne's cryptocurrency community; I argue attention operates as a process whereby narratives explaining longstanding socio-economic inequalities are converted into investment, business and software development strategies. Attention embeds relations of power by bringing together working-class people and capital holders to overcome the friction of turning online discourses into empirical fact. Together they endeavour to use cryptocurrencies to transform their relationship to capital. Consequently, attention produces a fragmented community constituted by uneven, contextual alliances across class. Differences between Bitcoin and programmable cryptocurrencies like Ethereum and Solana reveal the ways that Austrian economics and the logics of entrepreneurship, as forms of expertise, influence the affordances and shortcomings built into cryptocurrencies as socio-technical agglomerations. Attention helps to make the paradox of expertise legible in 'decentralised' and 'transformative' cyber-physical systems.

4

STS In/as Education

Simy Kaur Gahoonia (IT University Copenhagen), **Helene Friis Ratner** (Technical University of Denmark), **Bjarke Lindsø Andersen** (University College Absalon), **Lars Bo Andersen** (University College Copenhagen)

This is an open panel exploring the role, potential and challenges of STS research within education. The panel provides a forum for exchange and networking between researchers and research approaches and is, as such, open to all working at the intersection between STS and education.

With inspiration from the conference theme, we hope to engage in a renewed "infrastructuring" of educational researchers in Denmark, to invite new participants into the DASTS environment, and, perhaps, bridge the divide between STS research on/about education (analyzing education from STS-positions) and research on how to use STS as/in Education (doing STS as an educational endeavor). Contributions within this panel explore the following themes (but are not limited to these):

- Educational infrastructures - the ecologies of data, platforms and the forms of organizations that configure educational institutions and practices
- Technology comprehension (teknologiforståelse) - as an educational endeavor, a type of Bildung, a science-in-the-making, a teaching practice, a political project, a field of research
- AI and educational technologies – and all the negotiations, doubts, hopes, ambiguities and practices around technologies in contemporary education. Hereunder also the analog/digital socio-materialities of education – the everyday entanglements of the classroom between cloud services, handwritten jottings, discursive practices and gestures and voices of bodies in motion where clear boundaries between the analog and the digital dissolve
- Methods – STS is characterized by methodological inventiveness and pluralism, enabling new insights in and on education, from controversy mapping to interventionist approaches and beyond
- Pedagogical work, invisible labour and hidden perspectives – both the work of teachers and others in relation to technologies, but also the practices and perspectives of students that are, perhaps, hidden from both teachers and researchers

4.1. Children's Experiences of Agency in Gaps of Responsibility

Bjarke Lindsø Andersen (University College Absalon) **& Mikkel Hjorth** (University College VIA)

Contemporary AI debates describe responsibility gaps emerging in algorithmic infrastructures, where outcomes cannot be traced to a single human agent (Mattingly & Cibralic, 2025). While such analyses typically focus on adults or high stakes decision systems, far less is known about how children experience agency when engaging with generative systems embedded in these infrastructures. Drawing on two classroom interventions where pupils built an idea generation machine and a music recommendation algorithm, we examine how they negotiate authorship and responsibility. In group interviews (n=23), pupils attributed outcomes to "me", "us", "the class", "the dataset", "the system", or simply "it's all mixed together." Their frequent hesitation marks a moment where inherited categories for locating agency no longer apply. We argue that this hesitation reflects a lived encounter with responsibility gaps: pupils experience authorship as emerging from intertwined infrastructural contributions of data, peers, algorithms, and design constraints. We propose symbiotic agency (Hayles, 2025) to describe this distributed, emergent mode of acting, foregrounding how responsibility is felt and made sense of in children's micro practices.

Hayles, N. K. (2025). Bacteria to AI: Human Futures with Our Nonhuman Symbionts. University of Chicago Press. Mattingly, J., & Cibralic, B. (2025). Machine Agency. MIT Press.

4.2. A Critical Examination of AI Literacy: Lessons from Mathematics Education

Raimundo Elicer (Aalborg University)

The term artificial intelligence (AI) literacy is an often well-intended approach that drives mandated teaching and assessment of AI-adjacent topics to help navigating the so called "age of AI". I problematise the term and its implications, particularly from a perspective of literacy as massive representational structure for intellectual activities. I begin disambiguating AI as pure science, as applied science and as industry, as well as identifying three views on literacy: competence, awareness and infrastructure. As an extension to engage with AI literacy, I draw from the tradition of Critical Mathematics Education as a set of preoccupations: (1) the formatting power of mathematics, (2) the relation between mathematics education, democracy and social justice, and (3) pedagogical imagination. I highlight that all three preoccupations are exacerbated with the resource-intensive, opaque, connective computational models that compose the current wave of AI. AI literacy is, to some extent, contradictory as it conflates optimism on the preparedness for a future labour market with a critical engagement with artifacts driven by such technologies. To another extent, it is redundant with other kinds of literacy—most notable media and technological—literacies, as AI is one of many explosions of technological optimism that would require a similar critical stance as other technologies.

4.3. 'Speaking Without Communicating' in a High-stakes English Language Assessment

Jelena Popov (University College London)

This paper examines an AI-enabled English language test (PTE Academic) to explore how human–machine assemblages reshape educational infrastructures, learning practices and communicative norms in language assessment. Drawing on surveys, interviews and ethnographic observations, we use a socio-cultural-material (SCM) framework to analyse an ecosystem co-constituted by algorithmic agency, commercial testing ecosystems and global mobility aspirations. We show how test-takers orient towards the AI as a non-human interlocutor, developing hybrid speech genres characterised by loudness, continuous talk, agrammatical phrasing and template-based responses, strategies oriented not toward communication, but toward 'speaking in the way the AI likes.; These practices are enabled and constrained by opaque algorithmic scoring, the socio-material conditions of test centres, and a thriving intermediary infrastructure that interprets the test for users. Methodologically, we demonstrate how concepts of ecosystems, symmetry and compositional inquiry open new possibilities for STS in education by revealing hidden labour, emergent expertise and shifting relations between humans and machine learning systems. The paper contributes to debates on AI in education by showing how high-stakes assessment produces new socio-material worlds in which learning, communication and mobility are mediated by algorithmic and commercial logics

4.4. Praxiographic Enactments of University Students and Their Manifold Relationships with GenAI in University Education

Mikala Hansbøl (University of Copenhagen)

Strathern (2004) points at any interpretation inviting and refusing a number of possibilities, allways forming partial connections. From this point of departure, the ontological multiplicity (Mol, 2002) of things manifested in lived lives, with interpretations and their effects as practices, are a particular interest. Hansbøl (2009) research engagements with a digital knowledge sharing system as heterogeneously constituted. Within this approach, engagements are relationally understood, with the effect that full engagement approaches to digital systems, representing them as already existing platforms to act with and from, turn out to be unrealistic descriptions. GenAI chatbots are often represented as things to engage with. Suchman (2023) problematizes the "uncontroversial 'thingness' of AI". Gupta et al. (2024) emphasize the importance of understanding how different metaphors exist and take part in creating different landscapes to engage with, when it comes to developing critical AI literacies. This paper draws on qualitative interviews with 12 university students about their everyday study practices with(out) GenAI. Students' vocabularies and stories of (dis-)engagements with ChatGPT as "support teacher", "tool", "helping hand", "assistant director", "writing partner", "technology" and "machine" contributes to the field of research and educational approaches that aim to open up the ontological multiplicities of GenAI chatbots as partially existing objects in education.

4.5. New Data-Policy-Technology Infrastructures and Their Implications for Education Policy

Radhika Gorur (Deakin University)

Governments and intergovernmental organisations (IGOs) are increasingly advocating and embracing new data-policy-technology infrastructures in education policy and governance. This 'digital turn,' characterised by real-time data flows, predictive analytics, algorithmic modelling, dashboards and AI, is enabling new forms of 'data-driven decision-making' (DDDM) that appears distinct in significant ways from the 'evidence-based policymaking' (EBP) that has been the hallmark of neoliberal policymaking over the last four decades. Whereas EBP relied on cyclical, aggregated and retrospective forms of statistical reasoning, DDDM is oriented toward continuous, predictive, behavioural and individualised data, operating through automated, correlational and often privately managed data infrastructures. Policy advice is increasingly shaped by human-technology and public-private assemblages, often drawing on infrastructures and instruments developed by private knowledge brokers such as Microsoft.

This paper presents preliminary data from a project that examines how DDDM infrastructures are redefining the purposes, priorities and values of education. Using concepts from STS and critical data studies, the project focuses empirically on three key sites of education policymaking – the EU, the OECD and UNESCO – and is based on the analysis of documents and interviews with key education experts.

4.6. A Tale of How a Drop-out Algorithm Lost Its Powers: Predicting Student Dropout in Vocational Education

Helene Friis Ratner (Technical University of Denmark)

Predictive algorithms promise to pre-empt future events. In education, algorithmic prediction is increasingly used to profile students, flagging individuals at risk of disengagement, poor performance, or drop-out. Much critical scholarship has examined the harms of predictive algorithms, raising concerns about behaviourist pedagogies, bias, and surveillance. While important, these risk overlooking accounts that do not align with the 'algorithmic drama' (Ziewitz, 2016) of powerful and harmful algorithms. An alternative form of critique could be to examine how infrastructural figurations (fail to) sustain algorithmic power. To do so, this paper tells the story of how a drop-out algorithm in Denmark gradually lost its agency. Analysing the algorithm as a 'partially existing object' (Jensen, 2010), this analysis elicits how the infrastructural arrangements failed to sustain the drop-out algorithm and eventually stripped it from its powers. We conclude with reflections on the critical edge of a rather mundane story of a non-powerful algorithm. While it is crucial to critique the harmful deployment of algorithmic prediction in education, this type of critique also risks reifying algorithms as stable, coherent and agential objects. Examining 'failed' algorithms as the one studied here, allows us to understand how algorithms gain their powers from wider socio-technical infrastructures and helps unpack the "thingness" of AI (Suchman, 2023).

4.7. Tracing Educational Infrastructure: Open Source as Alternative to Big Tech Platforms

Emilie Mørch Groth (Technical University of Denmark)

In recent times, geopolitical uncertainty has sent ripples throughout Danish society, challenging the digital welfare state's relationship to (and dependency on) American big tech. This dependency is being problematised under the notion of 'digital sovereignty', and Danish schools are no exception. However, the influence of big tech platforms on Danish schools has long been publicly scrutinised: since 2019, 'the Danish Chromebook-case' has raised concerns on Google's data processes and the data rights of school children. In this landscape, big tech alternatives are being discussed, and often, open source is appointed as "the way out" of American dependency.

To further understand the contestation of big tech in schools and the emerging resistance, this presentation asks: How is open source framed as alternative educational infrastructure in terms of dependency, organisation, and regulation?

This is explored by tracing an emerging platform: The OS2skole project – an open source-based platform birthed as a data compliance-project in the wake of the Chromebook case and now positioned under the digital sovereignty banner – promising an alternative to big tech in Danish schools. With an offset in STS and Actor-Network theory, this work engages with education, through empirically tracing the open-source platform and the contestation of big tech in Danish schools.

4.8. Scaling Student Well-being with Edupreneurial Apps

Simy Kaur Gahoonia & Irina Papazu (IT University Copenhagen)

The ongoing concern of student well-being in Danish schools has received much attention recently. Established responses to this issue include a state-mandated yearly national well-being survey among students and the production of well-being indicators for unspecified municipal and school-level action. Meanwhile, a number of commercial actors, small Danish edtech ventures, have emerged, providing software applications (apps) for measuring, understanding and intervening in student well-being, promising to aid schools and teachers in addressing the issue. Combining STS, ethnographic and media studies approaches, we analyse the enactment of student well-being done by three apps that facilitate so-called micro measurements of well-being in schools. STS work has posited scaling as organisational method, a form of empirical philosophy, and shown how technical devices are deployed to make nebulous phenomena tangible through scale-making. We analyse founder interviews and conduct app walkthroughs to build an analysis of how scaling is employed in the affective work of edupreneurship, where people are, partly, motivated by their educator past in designing (often technical) solutions for educational problems. Our study explicates the contingent student well-being enactments at stake as these apps become nodes in pedagogical practice and institutional routines; and it discusses the opportunities in making scaling the object of analysis in STS-informed studies of edtech and edubusiness.

4.9. Science Studies and Codesign Models

Lars Bo Andersen (University College Copenhagen)

This paper presents a science study on the design and development of the new Danish curriculum "Technology Comprehension" (TF, teknologiforståelse) and discuss different models for the codesigning curricula between researchers, teachers and others. More precisely, the paper presents a mapping of theories and methods used by researchers in the national Knowledge Center for Digital Technology Comprehension in their ambition to design the TF curriculum with teachers and schools.

The analysis is based on the theory of social worlds and, more specifically, the concept of theory/methods packages. This framework allows us to investigate co-design processes as thoroughly ecological and dynamic processes between several intersecting social worlds where different actors are guided by different theory/methods packages.

The design of TC involves around 50 researchers from different fields and traditions trying to (co)design TC with each other and with teachers and pupils from 5 different schools. The slogan being, that TC should be developed "with" practitioners and "in" practice.

The presenters are responsible for coordinating this process and, as a first step, we sampled theories and methods from each of the centre's 10 research groups, asking for research that informs and guides their methods and approaches to the design and development of the TC curriculum. The research was mapped and used as a basis for codesign models throughout the process.

4.10. Creative Pragmatics: Performing STS In/as Education

Connie Svabo (Syddansk Universitet København)**, Andrew Pickering** (Exeter University), **Michael Shanks** (Stanford University), **Chunfang Zhou** (Syddansk Universitet København)**, Gitte Miller Balslev** (Syddansk Universitet København)**, Karina Kiær** (Syddansk Universitet København/UCSYD), **Katrine Bergkvist Borch** (Syddansk Universitet København)**, Maiken Westen Holm Svendsen** (Syddansk Universitet København)**, Tina Maria Brinks** (Syddansk Universitet København) **& Serhii Petrovych** (Syddansk Universitet København).

We explore how STS can be enacted as educational practice—shaping how learning environments are designed, inhabited, and performed.

Drawing on a transdisciplinary research programme at the University of Southern Denmark, we conceptualise knowing as situated, performative, and infrastructural. Learning is understood as the ongoing performance of knowledge in complex socio-material environments. This aligns with STS insights into science as practice, where knowledge emerges through entanglements of human and non-human actors, institutional arrangements, and infrastructures.

Building on pragmatist philosophy and STS, Creative Pragmatics foregrounds:

- knowledge as performance and achievement
- learning environments as (onto-)epistemic media shaping what can be known
- pedagogy as infrastructuring—the design of conditions for participation

In dialogue with the notions of "acting with the world" and the "mangle of practice," we argue that education can be reconfigured as a site of engagement, where learners participate in open-ended, collective processes of inquiry, design, and intervention.

Empirically, the paper draws on work from the FNUG research centre, including makerspaces, design-based STEM education, and curated learning environments, showing how STS-informed pedagogies engage contemporary educational infrastructures, while foregrounding agency and creativity.

4.11. Beyond the Human: How Student Teachers Use Speculative Design to Cultivate Planetary Perspectives on Future Technologies.

Vibeke Schrøder & Camilla Balslev Nielsen (University College Copenhagen)

Within current computer science education, the planetary implications of digitalisation remain largely unaddressed. From an STS perspective, this absence is reinforced by the naturalisation of digital technologies within dominant sociotechnical imaginaries, which renders their material and ecological infrastructures infrastructurally invisible in teaching practices (Selwyn, 2025; Suchman, 2007). The aim of this presentation is to examine how teacher education can prepare student teachers to teach responsibly and critically in, about, and with digital technologies by integrating computer science, STS perspectives, and planetary design into the curriculum (Engholm et al., 2025). In a learning design for technology comprehension in teacher education, we introduce STS and planetary design practices that encourage students question dominant human-centred assumptions and instead adopt broader, planetary perspectives when engaging with technological futures. We discuss the outcomes of the experiment by analysing post group interviews, speculative design artefacts and whole-class reflections.

Engholm, I., Borg, L., Frandsen, B., Funder, C. & Melchiorsen, H. (2024). Design Wise. Royal Danish Academy. Selwyn, N. (2025). Digital degrowth: Radically rethinking our digital futures. Polity. Suchman, L. A. (2007). Human-machine reconfigurations: Plans and situated actions. (2nd ed). Cambridge University Press.

4.12. Looking Beyond the Facade of Interdisciplinary Doctoral Programmes as Innovative Infrastructures

Piet Jan Pelle Boers (University of Copenhagen)

There is a growing prevalence of interdisciplinary Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions (MSCA) programmes. These programmes are put forward as frameworks for driving innovative doctoral research using collaborative infrastructures (CIs) which are presented in the Grant Agreement (GA).

Using ethnographic methods, I study the CIs of the INTERACT programme (an inter-institutional, interdisciplinary doctoral MSCA programme doing innovative STEM research on cancer). I argue that it proves difficult to provide a clear account of how such programmes realize either a shared CI or several uniform CIs. Rather, the situatedness of these actors produces a complex, interrelated mosaic of lived experiences that does not reflect the infrastructure presented in the GA. The CIs are negotiated and navigated mostly on a local level. Differences in supervisory practices exist not only between supervisory teams but even between main and co-supervisors. Moreover, many of the INTERACT PhD fellows do not only need to navigate these differences, but they also enable collaboration as they connect cross-institutional laboratories and supervisors. In this way, the PhD fellows do not simply use CIs, they become 'infrastructured' themselves.

I hope to open a discussion on how the presented CIs differ from the situated practices, how this difference affects the diverse range of actors within these programmes, and what this means for the innovative research being conducted.

4.13. Leadership with AI at Hand: Backdoor Technologies in Educational Leadership

Anja Pors & Jacob Sillesen (University College Copenhagen)

I et feltarbejde i dagtilbud 2025-2026 viser det sig, at ChatGPT glider ind i lederpraksis som en bagdørsteknologi; en teknologi som uformelt inviteres ind i organisationen og spredes socialt mellem ledere på forskellige niveauer. Sådanne former for skyggeAI udforskes aktuelt i forhold til juridiske problemstillinger, hvorimod vi med dette studie er interesserede i, hvordan teknologien finder vej ind i organisationen gennem social deling og hvordan spredningen påvirker sociale forventninger i samarbejdet mellem ledere. Vi undersøger mere specifikt, hvordan uautoriseret brug af generativ AI præger den ledelsesfaglige opgave, identitet, ekspertise og dømmekraft - med særlig interesse for hvordan rutiner, arbejdsgange og ansvarsfordelinger organiseres. Vi undersøger, hvad upåagtet bagdørsteknologi betyder for ledelsesfaglige glidninger mellem professionel og privat, pålagt og tilvalgt teknologi, formel og uformel brug. Analysen indskriver sig i organisationsetnografiske diskussioner af formalitet og uformalitet i offentlige organisationer, hvor bureaukratiets klassiske embedsetik udfordres og bidrager med analytiske greb til at forstå, hvordan ledelse aktuelt forskyder sig fra en professionel og pålagt styring til en personligt tonet og tilvalgt teknologiassisteret ledelse. Som bagdørsteknologi gør ChatGPT, at rutiner etablerer normative arbejdsbetingelser i daglig ledelsespraksis.

4.14. Marketdesignification

José Ossandón (Copenhagen Business School)

My interest here is to understand what market design does. To confront this question, in the STS tradition of Akrich, I compare the "technical scripts" in three instruments of marketisation that have been used in education: the school voucher, university course allocation systems, and the main implementation of market design in education, matching markets. With the school voucher the script comes from neoclassical economics: it is an attempt to unleash homo economicus, rational, selfish, competitive actors on both sides of the supply and demand curve of school systems. With the auction allocation system, the script is what Foucault called an entrepreneur of the self, and what in the more recent literature is known as the asset condition. It is an instrument supposed to make students behave as investors in human capital. What is the script of matching markets? The goal here is, perhaps surprisingly, to deactivate agents' strategic impulses. The key technical term is to develop "strategy proof mechanisms". Matching will work better if participants feel secure to share their actual preferences rather than to strategize on what information they might prefer revealing. To play the game but do not game the game. To characterize marketdesignification, I propose, we must try to conceptualize the strange personae that emerges in this context.

5

Limits of Life: Exploring the Infrastructures OfClassification, Delay, and Withdrawal in Biomedicine

Amalie Martinus Hauge, **Didde Boisen Andersen**, **Thilde Vegenfeldt**, **Sarah Wadmann**, **& Laura Emdal Navne** (VIVE: The Danish Center for Social Science Research)

Biomedical innovations often promise to extend, optimize, or repair life. Yet these interventions also raise profound dilemmas about where and how to draw the line. Decisions to pause, defer, withhold or withdraw treatment or care are not simply the result of technoscientific calculations; they rely on political and contingent valuations inscribed in complex and often invisibilized infrastructures. Prognostic tools, biomarker indications, reimbursement schemes, stratification logics, and digital decision aids make certain forms of intervention viable while rendering others obsolete, unthinkable, or undesirable.

By centering on limit making, the panel speaks to the 2026 theme of Encountering Infrastructures by asking: How do moral, economic, and planetary concerns become entangled in the infrastructures that limit, delay, or withhold biomedical intervention? What kinds of lives, treatments, and futures are enabled - or constrained - through these arrangements of care, hope and control?

This panel explores how biomedical limits are infrastructured across multiple domains from the clinical encounter over policy systems and planetary impact; how they are made and maintained through routines, classifications, and systems that shape present day care and long-term visions of life, health, and death. The panel also explores how these infrastructures generate and foreclose particular futures for particular individuals, positioning some at the center while marginalizing others.

5.1. The Arrival of a New Death. How Transplant Staff Experience the Emotional and Practical Challenges of Implementing Donation after Circulatory Death in Denmark

Anja Marie Bornø Jensen (University of Copenhagen)

While Donation after Circulatory Death (DCD) has rapidly expanded Denmark's donor pool, its implementation relies on extensive and often invisible work of medical professionals. Drawing on ethnographic observations, interviews, and document analysis, the paper shows how DCD requires careful staging of the dying process, reorganized clinical routines, new cross-disciplinary collaborations, and the negotiation of moral dilemmas at the limits of life and death. Staff describe DCD as more visbly "dead" than brain death, reshaping their emotional engagement, perceptions of the donor body, and practices of care. At the same time, the complex DCD process challenges organizational logics, electronic registration systems, and collegial responsibilities. The paper also highlights how DCD is strategically framed as not a new death, even as professionals encounter ambiguous bodies and emotionally intense scenarios that destabilize this narrative. Finally, I explore the contested terrain of pride and celebration surrounding the first successful DCD cases. While some staff experience the procedures as historic milestones worthy of recognition, others perceive celebrating as ethically inappropriate. Inspired by Scheer's notion of "emotional practices" (2012), Bell's theory of "ritualization" (1991) and Wahlberg's concept of "routinization" (2018), this paper discusses what it takes to introduce a historically significant new category of deceased organ donor in Danish hospital practice.

5.2. Infrastructuring the Future for Advanced Therapies in Europe

Lea Skovgaard, Zainab Afshan Sheikh, Jakob Wested (University of Copenhagen) **& Sarah Wadmann** (VIVE)

According to Geiger and Bourgeron (2025), the dominant model for pharmaceutical innovation has reached a 'peak', i.e. a tipping point where new approaches are urgently needed. The limits of this model are especially visible in the field of Advanced Therapy Medicinal Products (ATMPs), including gene, cell, and tissue engineered therapies. ATMPs hold significant potential for rare diseases, but high development and manufacturing costs combined with small patient populations have resulted in 'peak prices', failed price negotiations, and the withdrawal of products from the European market, delaying patient access. Consequently, European health systems increasingly face dilemmas about where to draw boundaries for access to expensive treatments.

Across Europe, alternative innovation models have begun to emerge. This paper examines the tensions and limitations arising from existing regulatory standards, funding models, and organizational structures in the ATMP field. Drawing on document analysis and 14 interviews with administrators, researchers, and clinicians in Denmark, Germany, Spain, Poland, and Italy, we explore how innovators at 'the margins' attempt to repair and challenge the constraints of 'peak pharma,' the logics guiding their efforts, and the infrastructural work involved. By tracing attempts to reshape current infrastructures to enable alternative pathways we track which futures are envisioned for ATMPs and how new boundaries for access are drawn in this process.

5.3. Transition Work at the End of Life – On How Professionals Time Dying

Thilde Sønderby Vegenfeldt, Amalie Martinus Hauge (University of Copenhagen; VIVE)

Advances in cancer treatment have expanded the number of available therapeutic options, meaning that illness trajectories rarely end simply because treatments run out. Clinicians must therefore increasingly help shape when and how patients' trajectories become oriented toward dying. Building on the sociology of illness trajectories, this article introduces transition work to describe the clinical labor involved in shifting patients from life prolonging trajectories to trajectories oriented toward the end of life. Based on ethnographic observations in Danish oncology and hematology departments, we examine how clinicians gradually reorganize trajectories around dying. We conceptualize transition work as the effort to align key dimensions of the trajectory so that dying can emerge as a coherent course of action. Our analysis identifies three such dimensions: temporal expectations of dying, valuations of remaining life, and the institutional conditions through which the end of life can be organized. Through practices such as scaffolding prognostic information, reframing evaluations from survival to meaningful remaining time, and coordinating institutional arrangements like hospice eligibility, clinicians work to stabilize transitions toward dying. By conceptualizing these practices as transition work, the article extends trajectory sociology and contributes to debates about how dying is organized in contemporary cancer care.

5.4. An Ethnographic Sensibility in Bioethics: How To?

Didde Boisen Andersen (VIVE)

Over the last decade, there has been a debate in bioethics about how empirical data and normative theory ought to be integrated, and in particular what role empirical insights should play in theory development. While some employ empirical data primarily as a means to refine or improve pre-existing normative frameworks, others argue for a more complementary relationship in which empirical and normative perspectives critically inform one another. Despite growing interest in integrating ethnographic fieldwork in the development of normative theories, there remains limited clarity about what it actually means to cultivate an ethnographic sensibility and how such a sensibility can be developed in practice. This paper contributes to the debate by shifting attention from outcomes to process. We argue that ethnographic sensibility should not be understood as a discrete methodological step aimed at producing a specific outcome, but rather as an iterative and dialogical process in which theoretical insights shape data collection as it unfolds, while empirical observations continuously inform, challenge, and refine emerging theoretical claims. By illuminating the craft of developing such a sensibility, we highlight the importance of designing collaborative and iterative research processes that allow normative theory and ethnographic insights to critically engage with one another, thereby enhancing the relevance of normative theory and its potential impact on practice.

5.5. Solidity and Solidarity: The Co-production of Disease Classification and Economic Concerns in Danish Healthcare

Sarah Wadmann, Anna B. Johansen, Amalie M. Hauge and Laura E. Navne (VIVE)

Celebrated as a scientific frontier for decades, precision medicine now gives rise to complex negotiations of limit-setting in healthcare. This paper explores a particular aspect of these negotiations: the co-production of disease classification and economic concerns. While driven by future imaginaries (Fujimura 2003) of reduced overtreatment (and overspending), these precision technologies come with high costs for already constrained healthcare systems. Drawing upon collaborative ethnographic research in Denmark since 2017, we trace negotiations about how to delineate the use of costly precision technologies across various clinical sites. In particular, we attend to the interplay of clinical and administrative meaning-making in the delineation of treatment eligible populations and the questions about in- and exclusion it raises in a publicly funded healthcare system founded on principles of universalism and equal access. Drawing upon classical STS-debates on boundary-work (Gieryn 1983, 2007) and the reification of facts (Latour & Woolgar 1979), we demonstrate how cell counts and cut-off points, used as fluid markers in laboratory and clinical settings, tend to 'harden' when translated into administrative systems. In this process of 'solidification', molecular markers of biological difference acquire new meaning as they come to demarcate limits to publicly funded healthcare and pose challenges to solidarity.

5.6. Professional Normativity and the Everyday Ethics of Treatment Limits in Contemporary Medicine: Ethnographic Observations

Amalie Martinus Hauge (VIVE)

Ethical deliberation in medicine is often framed as formal reasoning or organized committee work. From an STS perspective, however, ethics is enacted in practice. Building on ethnographic approaches to valuation and clinical work, this paper examines how ethical concerns are handled in the everyday "backstage" of clinical decision-makinginformal discussions among physicians that remain largely invisible despite their influence on both patient trajectories and professional norms.

The empirical basis of the study is ten months of ethnographic fieldwork in a hematology clinic, focusing on daily morning meeting, where questions of overtreatment, proportionality, and the limits of intervention are negotiated. We analyze how clinicians collectively make sense of what counts as "good" treatment by mobilizing and adjusting multiple repertoires of valuation.

We identify four recurrent repertoires of valuation: rescue and intervention, patient-centering, collegial support, and system orientation; each associated with particular moral ideals, justificatory forms, and interactional tones. These repertoires do not simply reflect stable norms but participate in their ongoing calibration. By tracing how decisions are made in practice, the paper shows how professional normativity and the boundaries of life and treatment are continuously negotiated within everyday clinical work, rather than solely at the level of policy or bioethical abstraction.

6

Future Infrastructures / Infrastructures of the Future in Planetary Crises

Chiara Carboni (Technical University of Denmark), **Frederik Schade** (University of Copenhagen), **Nina Frahm**, **Santtu Räisänen**, **Kasper Schiølin** (Aarhus University)

Throughout the 20th and 21st centuries, scientists, policymakers, and social movements have treated future planetary threats as central concerns for present-day social, economic, and political action. Whether caused by human-made risks such as nuclear winter, superintelligent AI, and genetic engineering, or by environmental catastrophes, pandemics, and extraterrestrial take-over, visions of planetary crises always imply some kind of irreversible ecological, economic and cultural destruction and a call to the global community to act collectively and with urgency before it is 'too late'. The collective recognition of planetary threats has always depended on different ways of making future crises present as matters of knowledge, imagination and politics. This includes scientific production, be it through Cold War era scenario planning, contemporary climate and pandemic modelling, or the growing niche of "Existential Risk" and 'Global Catastrophic Risk" studies. It also includes various ways to engage the public, such as citizen education initiatives, deliberative democracy, activism, and art. And not least, it includes institutions of national and international politics, where notions of crises impose upon current political realities. We claim that there is an infrastructural perspective to all this, which the panel seeks to further unfold.

This panel examines the relationship between infrastructure and the making of planetary crises. In particular, we are interested in exploring this relationship through contributions studying (1) infrastructures implicated in the production and circulation of knowledge and imaginations of planetary crises in different contexts and at different scales, and (2) the role of infrastructure, or their lack, in the planetary crises as they are imagined. Given the heterogeneous and multi-sited mobilization of planetary crises across various sites, we invite empirical research as well as contributions reflecting on conceptual and analytical approaches to the relationship between infrastructures and the making of planetary futures in crisis.

6.1. Maintenance Isn't Sexy: On the Absence of Labor and Social Reproduction in Imaginaries of Coastal Climate Adaptation in New York City

Megan Lynn Maurer (IT University of Copenhagen)

Facing the effects of climate change, cities around the world are adapting. In New York City, one strategy is urban green infrastructure. These sites, like rain gardens and parks, are intended to perform infrastructural functions like cooling, stormwater retention, and shoreline securitization, while also providing benefits like biodiversity and support for human well-being. In NYC much current investment in existing parks is aimed at such ends. These localized responses to planetary crises represent a re-infrastructuring of greenspaces, turning an amenity into a critical infrastructure. While this allows inflows of much needed resources to city parks, it also seemingly results in their abandonment. Sinkholes, dirty bathrooms, overgrown trails, and overflowing trash bins attest that investments in climate adaptation are not matched by investments in basic maintenance. Meanwhile, housing and drug crises are also re-infrastructuring parks: as sites of inhabitation for highly marginalized New Yorkers. Drawing on over 5 years of fieldwork, including interviews with park goers at 3 sites of green coastal adaption, this paper explores these tensions. It asks what kind of future landscapes are imagined in these green climate adaptation projects? What epistemological assumptions lead to the abandonment of everyday infrastructures? And how might local practices of social reproduction provide ways to reframe and politicize these failures?

6.2. The Recalcitrance of Plant Cells: How Scientists Translate Future Climates into Plant Genetics

Asmus Gregersen & Mette N. Svendsen (University of Copenhagen)

With the plant breeding approach de novo domestication, plant scientists seek to transform wild plants into high-yielding, climate-resilient crops to be used in a near future imagined as a place of unstable agricultural conditions. This strategy relies on reliable pathways – or infrastructures – of CRISPR-based genome editing to precisely target key domestication-associated genes. STS studies in this field have predominantly focused on the controversies and politics surrounding the introduction of GMOs to agriculture. Based on ethnographic fieldwork among plant scientists in Denmark, we instead explore how de novo domestication is practically enacted in laboratory work with quinoa cultivars. In this case, genetic engineering is imagined not as an existential risk to human health or ecosystems, but as an essential infrastructure for managing liveable environments in a future marked by climate change. We argue that plant scientists, through experimental work in greenhouses and laboratories, simultaneously enact gene-edited plants as a medium of knowledge production and intervention in future agricultural conditions. However, this work is challenging. The plant scientists struggle to establish effective protocols for genetic transformation, as quinoa is not only climate resilient but also resilient to gene editing. By attending to these difficulties, we direct attention to the material work of establishing infrastructures for translating future climates into plant genetics.

6.3. From Digital Sovereignty to Technopolitics: Reorienting Research and Policy

Frederik Schade (University of Copenhagen)

As digital sovereignty discourse gains prominence in international geopolitics, scholars struggle with its significant ambiguity. To aid theorization and policy, this paper aims to clarify the political rationality of digital sovereignty. At a first glance, a Foucauldian perspective seems to confirm its political ambiguity, as policy in this domain mobilizes techniques attributable not merely to political sovereignty but also to discipline and biopolitical security. However, as we show, a unifying tendency can be identified across international discourses on digital sovereignty whereby the technological consistently replaces the human as the primary problem and object of politics. Based on this observation and drawing on examples from US, Chinese, and European policymaking, we trace the particular technopolitical rationality underlying current digital sovereignty discourse, arguing that it signals a novel and under-researched convergence in international politics towards a techno-centric political orientation. Based on our analysis, we define technopolitical rationality as one of strategically enabling and harnessing widespread techno-social transformation(s) while avoiding undesirable technical constraints, particularly through practices of infrastructuring. This theory, we argue, equips us with a novel conceptual vocabulary to think through the politics of digital sovereignty across both research and policy.

6.4. Performing Scalability: How European Carbon Management Projects Anticipate an Infrastructure-to-come

Florian Skelton (Goethe University Frankfurt)

In the context of climate change, the gap between existing and projected infrastructure is particularly dramatic. European climate policy estimates that millions of tonnes of CO2, or carbon, need to be captured, transported and stored annually by 2030 to avert planetary crises. While the infrastructure to manage these gargantuan quantities is largely non-existent, a plethora of policies, actors and sociotechnical imaginaries anticipate its emergence. In this presentation, I examine how business actors developing carbon management practices are preparing for their roles within this envisioned infrastructure. For this, I build on ethnographic fieldwork that I conducted at five European carbon management projects at different scales, from a small biochar startup, over a technology provider to a large flagship project in the North Sea. Preliminary analysis suggests that these actors acutely recognize the near-impossibility of building the required infrastructure in time but nevertheless remain overtly optimistic regarding its emergence. This optimism, I argue, is a strategic performance of 'scalability' that is required to secure investments and political legitimacy. It is reinforced by a need to appear as 'innovative', an idealism of 'doing my part', a belief in technology's potential, or a perceived lack of alternatives. In short, I study how carbon management actors perform an infrastructure-to-come, imbuing a lack of infrastructure with a promise of planetary management.

7

Home as Infrastructure

Arshia Eghbali, **Mette Simonsen Abildgaard**, **Kirsten Gram-Hanssen**
(Aalborg University)

Since the dawn of the industrial era, homes have become increasingly entangled in networks of infrastructures, from running water and power grids to postal systems and telecoms, each adding new socio-technical layers onto domestic life and redefining what could be done from within the home, and what it means to be at home. Today, digital platforms, smart home technologies, on-demand logistics, digital public services, and remote work arrangements have added more complexity to these entanglements. As more domains of social, economic, and cultural life are reorganized around the home, the domestic sphere increasingly resurfaces as a form of infrastructure: a socio-material entity that underpins care, work, well-being, surveillance, and everyday life.

Similarly, the history of domestic sanitary reforms reminds us that concerns with ventilation, germs, and hygiene have long positioned the home as a public health infrastructure. Something that was only reinforced by our recent experience of a pandemic. Today, energy transitions, indoor environmental regulation, and sustainability concerns renew this infrastructural lens, connecting the materialities of domestic space to broader ecological and political questions. Moving beyond understandings of housing as a matter of physical stock, legislation, or finances, home-as-infrastructure foregrounds the home as a dynamic socio-technical system that requires ongoing maintenance and repair, coordinates social practices, and shapes possibilities for participation in public, economic, and cultural life.

- Housing as infrastructures of care, exploring how housing materialities, governance practices, and market dynamics enable or inhibit care across households and communities.
- Environmental infrastructures of housing, from energy usage and emissions to domestic sustainability practices and climate adaptation.
- Home as a health and wellbeing infrastructure, from nineteenth century sanitary interventions to present day concerns with indoor climate, safety, and the distribution of environmental risks.
- Smart homes, platformization, and digital domesticity, including datafication, AI, surveillance, and the embedding of homes within logistical and service networks.
- Working from home and the ‘work of working from home’, encompassing material, affective, and infrastructural labor.

7.1. Water Worlds: Making Relations Between the Urban Catchment, the Home and Urban Water Infrastructure

Stephanie Lavau (University of Melbourne)

In recent decades, concerns with climate change, urban growth and river health have driven a shift towards integrated urban water management, which operates at the confluence of water services, urban planning, environmental protection, and the liveability of cities. This has been frequently accompanied by a concurrent shift away from the infrastructure of 'Big Water' (Sofoulis 2005) and towards what we might instead characterise as 'micro-infrastructure'; more distributed, smaller scale technologies that deliver multiple benefits, including rainwater tanks and rain gardens on private property. In this period of transition, my research has explored the ways in which urban water infrastructure reaches into the private sphere of the home, and the implications for the 'hydro-social contract' (Farrelly and Brown 2014). In this paper, I attend to the ways in which inner city residents in Melbourne, Australia, make relations between the urban catchment, water infrastructure and their home. These relations constitute distinct 'water worlds' in which urban residents and their home figure within a broader socio-material field of action and responsibility for water.

7.2. Padding Sanitary Infrastructures in Danish Nursing Homes: Rethinking Sustainable Transitions in Elderly Care

Morten Krogh Petersen & Victoria Ankerstjerne (Kolding School of Design)

This contribution ventures into a specific kind of home: Danish nursing homes. Here, many residents live with incontinence, and sanitary infrastructures are sustained through incontinence pads, referred to as diapers in the nursing home setting. Their use gives rise to care practices such as placing used diapers in transparent bags, transporting them from residents' apartments to central collection points, and care workers hiding them behind their backs when relatives are encountered in the corridors.

In nursing homes, then, sanitary infrastructures are not visible only in moments of breakdown (Star, 1999). Rather, their (in)visibility flickers (Law & Singleton, 2005). Drawing on Brian Larkin's suggestion that "what is background for one person is a daily object of concern for another" (2013, p. 336, see also Carse, 2012), we examine when, where, how, and why bodily waste is rendered (in)visible. Sanitary infrastructure, we show, operates not only through technical arrangements but also care workers' practical engagements with social norms of odor, dignity, and bodily exposure.

As elderly continence care is redesigned in less resource-intensive ways, technical optimization alone risks leaving care workers as padding for existing sanitary infrastructures. We suggest that this padding work deserves greater analytical and design attention, as it may reveal overlooked possibilities for imagining and materializing sustainable transitions otherwise in elderly care and beyond.

7.3. Atmospheres for Rent: Retro-Vintage Homes and the Platformization of Domestic Life

Arshia Eghbali (Aalborg University)

Using a corpus of more than 8,000 images from Copenhagen Airbnb listings, this contribution examines how platformized short term rental infrastructures mediate domestic aesthetics. Contrary to the stereotype of standardized grey, IKEA furnished interiors, this research reveals heterogeneous homes with retro vintage aesthetic sensibilities. The analysis focuses on how images and descriptions convey and sell retro atmospheres that can be booked, compared, and exchanged within tourism logistics and service networks. Rather than flattening difference, the platform renders atmospheric qualities legible and tradable as "home vibes." Through the lens of home as infrastructure, the study shows how domestic images function as interfaces between host inhabitants and guest inhabitants, embedding homes in the everyday landscape of platformized tourism and digital domesticity. This offers a twofold outcome: first, it provides an archive of contemporary home cultures, aesthetics, and design, accessed through the digital infrastructure of short term rental; second, it shows how those images operate as marketable promises in a datafied urban economy.

7.4. Home as Ecological Relation: Rethinking Law's Infrastructural Production of Home

Miriam Cullen & Katarina Hovden (University of Copenhagen)

Law plays a significant role in delimiting and validating what constitutes "home". Disparate fields of law assume that the "homes" worthy of protection are the buildings and infrastructure of the propertied white man, the "archetypal subject" of law, the "reasonable person" in many a legal test. This paper forms part of a broader inquiry into the way in which the law has colonized the homemaking space and reduced the otherwise rich and intimate characteristics of home, to monetary values, ownership and transaction. The legal production of home extends beyond the delimitation of ownership and entitlements, as the law is embedded in, and co-constitutive of, the socio-materialities of home and place. This paper inquires into the relational assumptions underpinning dominant legal-infrastructural enactments of home, particularly as they concern the relations of people to the more-than-human world. In law, "home" is predicated on a human/nature dichotomy, rendering the home a sanctuary from the outside and "the other." While the infrastructural shifts attention to the more-than-human and to the elements of infrastucture - be that water, heating, or food production – are embedded in an instrumental relation, where the more-than-human is organised in service of people. In thinking with alternative relational imaginaries, we advance the notion of home as an ecological relation to reimagine law and its instruments in ways that better ensure both epistemic and interspecies equity.

7.5. Home to the Future – A Sustainable Utopia

Kirsten Gram-Hanssen, Toke Haunstrup Christensen & Mette Mechlenborg (Aalborg University)

A sustainable future includes substantially reduced consumption of energy and materials from our everyday life. Visions of such futures are often associated with new types of dwellings and infrastructures, though the premise for the future sustainable housing is to have as limited new built as possible. New construction is resource intensive, and there are many buildings in affluent societies which could be utilized better. The average space occupied per person in the global North is steadily growing, following from a demographic change with more elderly people staying alone in homes build for families, and where affluence and status imply building new and bigger. The outset of this chapter is the understanding that everyday practices are hold together by elements such as materiality, norms and meanings, and we will discuss how we can envision and obtain more sustainable living with as little changes to the existing materiality as possible. The chapter introduces the concept of rightsizing and based on literature, presents a typology of different sufficiency measures that can be implemented to improve the use of the existing buildings, including sharing homes and dividing big homes. In the promotion of such new ways of living, we may learn from how existing norms of housing emerged. Our recent research explores what previously lead to changing housing ideals and results from studying the past will be put in relation to promoting our ideas of sufficiency in residential living.

8

Environmental Encounters with AI: Infrastructural Worldings and Destabilizations

James Maguire and Michael Hockenhull (IT University Copenhagen)

We are currently witnessing an explosion in Artificial Intelligence (AI) discourse. Not just as an object of contemporary obsession, but also as a strategic and geopolitical concern across various continents. Reports and assessments are effusive both in their fear and fascination as governing entities across the globe hurriedly proceed to develop AI futures roadmaps. In tandem with this, we are seeing gargantuan trillion-dollar investments in AI as the industry begins to translate its imaginary of near exponential computational growth into more mundane infrastructural practices: the metals, materials, codes, chips, cables, turbines, datacentres through which AI is made materially and politically manifest.

It is this panel's contention that the imagining, building, and deploying of such infrastructures generate sites of environmental encounter, sites that illuminate many of the issues (material, temporal, and political) at the heart of the climate and ecological emergency. While the sheer quantity of resources that AI is forecasted to consume makes it difficult to imagine how its technosolutionist claims to sustainability can be realized, what is being imagined, proposed, and developed are new sites of environmental encounter. Sites where AI simultaneously destabilizes old arrangements and worlds new ones.

The environmental impacts of AI as a planetary infrastructure are legion, destabilizing not just planetary boundaries and thresholds, but human and multi-species populations, knowledge formations, and forms of politics and governance. At the same time the emerging role of AI within environmental, ecological, and climate settings contributes to new formations of power, new hopes and ideologies, as well as an array of divisive knowledge making practices. Common here is the deployment of AI within multiple climate mitigation and adaptation arenas, which in turn are re-configuring the epistemic and ontological moorings of environment making practices and politics.

This panel invites papers that explore environmental encounters with AI. While papers can address the panel's title in whatever empirical, conceptual, or methodological way they see fit, it particularly welcomes contributions that examine the environmental impacts of AI as a planetary infrastructure, and/or papers that examine the emerging epistemic, ontological, and political role of AI within environmental and climate related projects.

8.1. Cloud Regionalities: Tracing the Peripheral(s) in Hyperscale Computing Centres

Eduardo Luersen (University of Basel)

The rhetoric of digital infrastructure development is steeped in postindustrial epistemological assumptions. Yet scenes from the regional geographies of the cloud suggest otherwise. Hyperscale data centres are inherently resource-intensive, housing not only computing equipment but also non-computational infrastructure, such as air conditioners and generators, to sustain continued global data services. As geo-distributed hubs for data routing, they at once decentralise and concentrate processing and energy consumption, reconfiguring the physical spaces in which they are installed. While extensive research has focused on the interiors of data centres, far less attention has been paid to their external surroundings. This paper presents findings from ethnographic fieldwork conducted since 2023 in data centre-dense regions across Germany, Switzerland, and the Netherlands. Drawing on field notes, photography, maps, and soundscape recordings, it reinterprets the regional geographies where cloud infrastructure providers are sited. Facilities are typically located on exurban perimeters, near airports, power plants, and factories, often tracing previous logistical hubs—ports, large-scale storage, and package routing networks—from which they link to Internet Service Providers, Exchange Points, and the wider global network of computers. With this, rather than aiming to reveal anything hidden, the paper reframes the mundane dimension of digitality, with which we suppose great familiarity.

8.2. To Hyperscale or Not: Data Centers and the Reshaping of Place Across Locations

Brit Ross Winthereik (Technical University of Denmark) **& Karen Waltorp** (University of Copenhagen)

In this presentation we wish to discuss a project idea that compares two rapidly emerging data center regions in Zealand, Denmark and Cape Town, South Africa. In the project we propose to understand the transformation of place by AI data centers through analytics that mobilize the concept of "the hyperscale". The hyperscale bears on environmental and political change: It is resource extractive, driven by Silicon Valley imaginaries, and connects locations virtually. Grounded in infrastructure theory and ethnographic fieldwork in Denmark and South Africa, we seek to understand and further substantiate how data industries seek emplacement and how their needs challenge environmental relations and political autonomy and authority locally. Our ethnographic work calls for conceptualizing infrastructure studies in ways that stretch current understandings of infrastructure as multi-ontological and multi-species arrangements to also include multi-dimensional and multi-scalar registers. Ultimately, the project seeks to elucidate how places and communities are reshaped through increasing employment of AI, advancing research on infrastructuring and the significance of digitalization in constituting place.

8.3. Infrastructural Misalignments: AI Datacenters and the Politics of Constraint

James Maguire (IT University of Copenhagen)

The electrification of Denmark is proceeding at a rapid pace, putting the country's grid infrastructure under severe pressure. Reports of ten-year delays for grid connection are not uncommon as the system's connectivity pipeline has become overburdened with energy access requests. While electric vehicles and heat pumps are but two green technologies contributing to such growth in demand, it is large energy consumers that are putting untold strain on the structural integrity of the system. Datacenters (and more recently AI datacenters) are taking up many of the future connectivity spaces in the grid queue, with consumption forecasts totaling 75% of current grid capacity. So, while renewable energy generators and datacenter operators accelerate their plans to produce and consume energy at vast scales across the country, it is the slow mediation work of the grid operator (Elnet) that anchors the infrastructural politics of energy. While such slowness emerges as a response to various infrastructural misalignments (temporal, ideological, and strategic) that the grid operator has to mediate in living up to its triple public mandate (security of supply, cheap prices, and green energy), it also works as an analytical opening through which to think about the coming wave of AI datacenters to Denmark. What the presentation dwells upon is the potentially productive nature of such infrastructural misalignments as AI futures begin to encroach upon and cannibalize Danish energy futures.

8.4. Consumption at the Source: Energy Positionality and Environmental Encounters with Local LLMs

Mark Friis Hau (Roskilde University)

Despite growing awareness, the environmental costs of large language models remain opaque. Platforms like ChatGPT disclose no energy data, leaving AI's impact acknowledged in principle but unmeasurable in practice. Grounded in Critical Data Studies, we argue that local LLM deployment is the infrastructural condition under which environmental transparency becomes possible. We develop energy positionality: the situated, felt awareness of what computation costs in energy, treating transparency as its own form of environmental encounter. Through autoethnographic measurement sessions using local LLMs, we examine what becomes knowable when energy is measured at the point of use, how that knowledge takes shape in practice, and how cloud infrastructures displace such encounters. Our findings show that local deployment re-situates AI's environmental effects from distant infrastructures to the site of interaction, where computation becomes perceptible as resource consumption. This does not resolve AI's environmental costs, but it makes them accessible, visible, and legible. The paper contributes a conceptual framework (energy positionality), a transparency framework (local LLM deployment with dual measurement protocols), a methodological approach (autoethnographic energy sensing), and an infrastructural argument: that different AI architectures produce fundamentally different possibilities for environmental encounters, and therefore for knowing what AI does to the world.

8.5. Bots, Agents and AI Overviews: On Infrastructural Infiltration of ESG Knowledge Practices

Michael Hockenhull (IT University of Copenhagen)

The paper suggests the notion of "infiltration" to describe how AI is quickly becoming (part of) a planetary infrastructure that cannot be avoided, even if one should want to. Based on research into ESG reports, and the development of digital methods tools for exploring such reports, the paper explores the rise in forced yet subtle encounters with AI systems. These systems take three different forms: 1) the rise of specially trained AI models related to environmental purposes such as ClimateBert or ClimateGPT, 2) the growing practice of agentic programming and 3) the general epistemological effect of AI systems such as ChatGPT, and their integration into knowledge practices such as internet searching. Rather than describe a direct encounter with the environmental impacts of such AI, the paper proposes infiltration as an alternative or supplementary mode of experiencing AI systems, which is that of a slow take-over that cannot be easily accounted for. As simultaneously a concept from hydrological science, as well as one used in military or other covert contexts, infiltration describes a process which can ambivalently be thought of as both impersonal and malevolent. Thus the paper highlights how ESG and programming work both face constant yet diffuse infiltration from AI. The paper thus attempts to provide a primarily descriptive and conceptual contribution to our understanding of encountering AI.

8.6. Extractive Infrastructures, Kinship and Cognition

Peter Bukovica Gundersen (University College Absalon) **and Anastassia Vybornova** (University of Copenhagen)

This paper takes the narrative form of an open letter written from the perspective of "we, the columbite–tantalite (coltan) family" to examine AI infrastructures through the intersection of cognition and kinship. Drawing on Katherine Hayles' distinction between cognizers and non-cognizers and Donna Haraway's notion of compost-based kinship, the columbite-tantalite family uses the letter to explore how they become collectively implicated in AI systems. Columbite–tantalite, while a non-cognizer in its geological state, becomes transformed through extraction and refinement into a functional component of distributed cognitive assemblages. The role of tantalum in capacitors and power regulation situates it as part of the infrastructural conditions that sustain large-scale computation and machine cognition. This transformation repositions material within processes of interpretation and selection, integrating it into cognitive operations. In their open letter, the columbite-tantalite family argues that this produces a novel form of relation: an imposed kinship grounded in participation in cognition and shaped by extractive infrastructures. This form of kinship operates through asymmetrical relations and conditions of conscription. As the columbite-tantalite family suggests to us humans in their letter, AI infrastructures function as regimes that conscript matter into cognition, producing forms of relation that exceed existing accounts of kinship, agency, and responsibility.

9

Governance of and by National and Transnational Infrastructures

Annalisa Pelizza (Aarhus University & University of Bologna) & **Torben Elgaard Jensen** (Aalborg University)

STS and Infrastructure Studies identify "infrastructures" as a distinct sociomaterial form, characterized vis-à-vis "systems" and "platforms" by its heterogeneity of components, multiplicity of uses, and process-based methodologies. Infrastructures provide STS researchers with the possibility to identify agency in minor details and follow it across scales, sectors and established boundaries. This is clearly revealed in research on governance of and by infrastructures. Governance of infrastructures refers to large-scale ordering efforts led by policy actors. But governance can also be exerted through minor proxies such as standards, operative procedures, and technical components, with broad consequences (i.e., governance by infrastructures).

From intellectual property to population management, from urban security to the curbing of pandemic outbreaks, in the last decade infrastructures have increasingly been delegated governance functions. Recent advances in AI, interoperability and digitalization more broadly have motivated national and transnational policy actors to attempt to lead, regulate, orchestrate, and stimulate the infrastructural creation of techno-social orders and digital futures.

This panel examines the processes of governance of and/or by infrastructure empirically, methodologically or theoretically.

9.1. Nordic AI Governance: Comparing Emerging Patterns of Digital Statecraft

Torben Elgaard Jensen & Alexander Gamerdinger (Aalborg University)

After several years where AI has been discussed as a shockingly new phenomenon arriving from the tech industry with associated promises and fears, national governments now increasingly emerge as actors that aim to regulate and configure AI. While governments initially sponsored experimental and explorative pilot projects, later responses attempted to develop more coherent national AI strategies alongside efforts to infrastructure AI.

Corresponding roughly to the development from the-shock-of-the-new, to pilot projects, to more coherent government responses, there has been three waves of AI governance studies: Studies of policy discourse (e.g. Bennani-Taylor 2024), studies of pilot projects (Ratner & Schrøder 2024), and studies of emerging government attempts to orchestrate and infrastructure the use of AI (Laage-Thomsen et al. 2025, Räisänen 2025).

Our paper contributes to the third wave of studies through a comparative study of AI governance and infrastructuring in four highly digitalized Nordic welfare states: Denmark, Sweden, Finland, and Norway. We analyse more than 250 public sector AI initiatives and map out key dimensions related to implementation and scaling, choice of dominant technologies, governance organization, and funding.

Reflecting on differences and similarities between the countries, we spell out the variety of notions of AI as potential common good or infrastructure that is currently performed within Nordic digital statecraft practices.

9.2. Critical Data Design in Practice: A Case Study of NGO Intervention in China's Environmental Information Infrastructures

Vivian Wei Guo (IT University of Copenhagen)

Environmental pollution has become critical in China due to decades of rapid industrialization. The state has driven pollution governance through regulation, yet enforcement remains challenging because of local protectionism, fragmented bureaucracies, and information asymmetries. To address these issues, the state has built environmental information systems such as monitoring platforms, public disclosure tools, and the corporate environmental credit system (CECS). These systems aim to support more effective regulation, but enforcement is still weakened by poor data sharing, limited coordination, and uneven local implementation. Existing research views such systems as policy innovations and evaluates their impacts on companies and pollution control. However, few studies examine information systems through STS perspectives or explore ethnographically how these systems are enacted and contested by civil society in non-Western contexts. I address these gaps by asking: How do environmental NGOs intervene in the CECS and reshape pollution governance in China? I analyze a Shanghai-based environmental NGO specializing in data and IT, which in 2018 began evaluating CECS enforcement. My findings show that the NGO not only monitored the process but also acted as a critical data designer, intervening in national and local information systems, reshaping how environmental credit data was produced, interpreted, and used, and thereby influencing how pollution governance operated in practice.

9.3. New Nordic Platforms? a Three-dimensional Framework for Understanding Emerging Democratic and Digitally Sovereign Social Media

Andreas Birkbak (Roskilde University)

This paper examines the emerging landscape of "European" social media through a comparative lens inspired by the New Nordic Food movement. While manifestos that emphasize locality can mobilize significant attention, they often fragment into multiple interpretations in practice. Similarly, current calls for "European" or "Nordic" social media generate enthusiasm while leaving key terms - such as European, democratic, and local - underspecified and contested.

The paper argues that to analytically grasp these developments, emerging platforms must be understood as positioning themselves along three intersecting dimensions: territorial grounding, democratic values, and alternative business models. Each dimension is historically anchored in prior layers of social media development: early nationally or linguistically bounded platforms, the rise and regulation of global big tech infrastructures, and the proliferation of alternative, often decentralized or non-profit platforms.

Drawing on a review of these trajectories, the paper presents the Nordic Media Lab and four associated Danish platforms as an empirical case. This case illustrates how even within a shared "Nordic" framing, platforms articulate divergent responses to questions of locality, governance, and economic organization. The paper concludes by proposing a three-dimensional analytical framework that captures these tensions and provides a tool for studying the broader emergence of explicitly grounded social media.

9.4. Illuminating Mistrust: Quantum Light and the Politics of Trust in the European Quantum Communications Infrastructure.

Roque Manuel Jimenez Sumalave (Goethe University Frankfurt)

Communication is an act of trust. From cables to encrypted messaging, securing information exchange has always required delegating control to intermediaries and accepting their vulnerabilities. The European Quantum Communication Infrastructure (EuroQCI) is the EU's most ambitious attempt to redesign this process at a continental scale. It connects member states through laboratories, satellites, and fibre networks, grounded in the idea that physics can achieve what institutions have struggled to guarantee. Quantum Key Distribution (QKD) is central to this vision. It encodes cryptographic keys in the quantum properties of individual photons, responding to a condition of structural mistrust: the assumption that any human intermediary may be compromised. Because quantum states cannot be measured without disturbance, photons enable the detection of interference. In this framework, photons become the trusted actors. Drawing on multi-sited ethnographic fieldwork, this paper examines what happens when this vision meets material limits. Photons attenuate; beyond ~100 km, signals degrade. The solution is the trusted node that reintroduces human-controlled sites handling decrypted keys. Physics gives way to contracts and institutions.EuroQCI thus redistributes mistrust rather than eliminating it.

9.5. The European Digital Identity: A Novel Trans-national Ecosystem Co-shaping Identity, Technology and Administration

Annalisa Pelizza (Aarhus University & University of Bologna)

In the past decades the digital infrastructuring of administrative informational assets has imperceptibly but de facto laid the foundations to alter state institutional orders. This is particularly revealed when observing infrastructures of identification designed to informationally manage a crucial asset of state-building: populations. Such infrastructures articulate new ways of concomitantly producing individual identities, technologies and administrative assemblages.

Drawing on the ongoing development of the European Digital Identity infrastructure, I will show how the way citizens are digitally identified cannot be disentangled from the way software artifacts are designed, nor from the reordering of chains of actors involved in administrative knowledge production. Producing technology oriented to self-sovereign-identity (the Wallet) implies self-responsible individual subjects (identity), and goes hand in hand with the creation of a new administrative class made of public entrepreneurs and private consultants.

I eventually argue that such work of infrastructuring for people's identification de facto sows capabilities that alter the relationships between actors established as part of the modern project. Capabilities show that statehood is not only endowed to leaders, administrators and policymakers, nor is it always visible in policy: it can emerge as the more or less intentional and contingent outcome of work of infrastructuring.

10

Vulnerability In, by and of Care Infrastructures in Digital Health

Henriette Langstrup, **Bianca Jansky**, **Jonas Stage & Frederike Fahse**
(University of Copenhagen)

Digital infrastructures are increasingly the backbone of healthcare. Contemporary healthcare, both in the clinic and at home, depends on digital infrastructures in unprecedented ways. Socio-technical ecologies (Bowker & Star 1999) of digital health can include clinical decision-making, cross-sectorial coordination and data sharing, as well as individual patients' online navigation of access and self-management/care with digital health technologies and apps.

Digital infrastructures are the tracks that care should travel on to enable better and more personalized, efficient, and accessible healthcare. They offer opportunities but also risks. STS scholars have shown they can aggravate vulnerabilities of citizens (Lomborg et al. 2020), impede their access to care (Dakin et al. 2024), individualize the burden of care and reduce the response-ability of health care providers. Moreover, it is increasingly becoming clear that digital care infrastructures themselves are becoming vulnerable to shocks, exploitation and breakdowns in a world characterized by political unrest, Big Tech monopolies (Sharon 2021), and climate change (Crawford 2021).

Within this panel we want to bring together conceptual and empirical explorations of digital health care infrastructures as socio-technical arrangements that can be vulnerable and can cause vulnerabilities (Hommels et al. 2014). We understand vulnerabilities not as an individualized characteristic of people, technologies or groups, but rather as political, relational, and related to power (Gallistl et al. 2024, 2). Problems of digital exclusion, lack of interoperability and transparency, and most recently digital sovereignty issues are just some of the concerns accompanying digital health care infrastructures. We want to focus on accessing and engagement with the care infrastructure, maintaining of the care infrastructure, and people's knowledge of the care infrastructure.

Some questions to address:

- Vulnerability by infrastructure: How are digital care infrastructures producing or exacerbating vulnerabilities (of patients, citizens, healthcare providers, nature/climate)?
- Vulnerability of infrastructure: How are digital care infrastructures fragile, prone to breakdown or vulnerable due to external dependencies?
- Vulnerability in infrastructure: How do such vulnerabilities create ambiguous data experiences, shaping people's engagement with infrastructures?
- How are such vulnerabilities already addressed through repair and maintenance work and with which consequences for whom?
- How do we cultivate more resilient and response-able digital care infrastructures?

10.1. Human-Machine Vulnerability in the Logistics of Care

Benjamin Lipp (Technical University of Denmark)

Hospital care increasingly depends on vast digital infrastructures of logistics. Particularly, the automation of logistics is promoted as a way to increase efficiency and productivity. This contribution examines the operation and maintenance of autonomous mobile robots for goods transport in a regional soon-to-be super hospital. While the initial vision foresaw robots operating 'on their own', the system is ridden with breakdowns and intensified (repair) work for logistics and technical staff. This repair work is itself vulnerable, caught between unions' efforts to get compensation and management's dedication to contain costs. Nevertheless, logistics staff see this work as vital for maintaining the logistics of hospital care. They don't just care for the vulnerability of robots (Lipp, 2023) but for the care workers and patients that need goods delivered. This contribution hence offers an avenue for theorising human-machine vulnerability as produced by, in, and mediated through logistical infrastructure of care. Moreover, it shows how these vulnerabilities are embedded within wider techno-political imperatives of austerity, robotic innovation, and 'just-in-time' logistics.

10.2. Vulnerability and Strength: Building Cross-border Data Infrastructures in a Time of Geopolitical Turmoil

Klaus Høyer (University of Copenhagen)

In March 2025, the European Health Data Space (EHDS) Regulation came into force. It lays out new rules for health data usage and gives the mandate to build two digital infrastructures for sharing of health data for clinical and research purposes. According to the EU President, it marks an important step towards a European Health Union. However, it is enacted at a time when the American suppliers of the technology typically needed to achieve this type of integration are increasingly viewed in a new and more fearful light. The second Trump administration has cast significant doubts on the alliance between the EU countries and the US. How are European policymakers reacting to the geopolitical turmoil? Who can trust whom? It is as if actors and networks constantly dissolve, transform, and reunite in this sea of vulnerability and strength. This paper reflects on the dynamics involved and the implications for healthcare.

10.3. The Public Budgeting- And Accounting System: A Forgotten Digital Care Infrastructure for Danish Healthcare

Ida Schrøder (IT University of Copenhagen)

Since the 1970's, the present public Budgeting- and Accounting System (BAS) has been both a solid backbone of the public sector and a fragile system in need of constant care. It divides bodies into medical and social problems. It coordinates by earmarking budgets to one version of the body rather than the other. It aggregates bodies into opaque, yet comparable numbers. And it – not least – engages professionals as well as citizens in maintenance and repair of its incomplete standardizations. Despite of its durability and fragility, it is probably the digital care infrastructure that most often falls out of the scope of research on digital care infrastructures. In approaching the public BAS as a digital care infrastructure, I cross-fertilize critical accounting studies with STS studies of digital infrastructures to explore what role this system plays in coordinating citizen bodies across the social- and psychiatric healthcare sectors. Based on a document analysis of Danish accounting documents related to the coordination of interventions for young persons with severe social- and psychiatric problems, we trace the parallel durability and fragility of this coordinating work. This duality makes us wonder: What if the backbone of the public sector is not durable? What if we could change it? Which new tracks would we like care to travel on?

10.4. Infrastructuring Futures, Configuring Vulnerability

Ida Terp Høybye (Aarhus University)

Digital health infrastructures are often framed as enabling better, more efficient, and personalized futures of care. STS research has, however, shown that digital care infrastructures can simultaneously produce and redistribute vulnerabilities (Dakin et al., 2024; Danholt & Langstrup, 2012; Lomborg et al., 2020). But how are these vulnerabilities tied to the futures that infrastructures are built to realize? This presentation explores how STS approaches to futures, including the concept of sociotechnical imaginaries (Jasanoff & Kim, 2015), can shed light on how conditions of vulnerability take shape in digital health infrastructures. It draws on an ongoing PhD project on Danish biobanks, examining how visions of collective health, data sharing, and welfare become embedded in infrastructural arrangements and everyday practices. Based on a preliminary literature review and emerging project design, the presentation outlines how STS has conceptualized futures in relation to practice and infrastructures in health contexts. It suggests that imaginaries not only guide infrastructural development but also configure relations of dependency, responsibility, and participation. The presentation uses the case of biobanking to discuss how attending to futures may shift how we approach questions of vulnerability in digital health infrastructures.

10.5. Vulnerabilities in Cross Sectoral Data Sharing: Ambiguous Data Experiences in Care Infrastructures

Jonas Thorborg Stage & Henriette Langstrup (University of Copenhagen)

Visions of seamless, cross-sectoral data sharing promise to strengthen care. In Denmark, this ambition takes form in Samblik, which makes data visible across hospitals, general practice and municipal services. Drawing on fieldwork and interviews, we show how Samblik not only enables coordination but also produces vulnerabilities in, by and of digital care infrastructures. Healthcare professionals report new forms of data ambiguity as expanded visibility introduces uncertainty about what they may access, how to interpret it, and what responsibilities follow. For example, Municipal providers face fragile jurisdictions and limited organisational support, making legally permitted access feel morally and professionally risky amid nationally publicised 'misuse' cases. We term this type of data experience, one of several we identify, 'data trespassing'. Understood as charged experiences of potential overstepping that prompt risk-averse practices—reducing use, seeking cover (e.g. explicit consent), or avoiding some data. These practices surface vulnerabilities at several levels produced by the infrastructure with redistributed responsibility, the infrastructure itself with incomplete data, weak guidance and training, and of the infrastructure with a dependence on ongoing data and alignment work. These mixed data experiences highlight how digital infrastructures actively (re-)configure care, producing both new possibilities and insecurities.

10.6. Enacted Vulnerability in Video Consultations.

Johannes van den Heuvel (Copenhagen Academy for Medical Education and Simulation)

As a relatively new infrastructure in Danish general practice, video consultation was first introduced (with a payment plan) in 2020 as a crisis tool due to COVID-19. From 2025, video consultations have become an obligatory tool for general practitioners under their regional agreements. Therefore, I find it pertinent to understand how video consultations mediate, influence, and take part in enacting vulnerability in general practice. In my research, I explore vulnerability as any practices that increase the risk of producing a greater wrong for an actor. I also introduce an STS perspective on this by drawing on Annemarie Mol and Jeanette Pols's work on practice-as-ethics and ANT's understanding of networks and mediation. This leaves me with an understanding of vulnerability as a negotiation within a network of humane and non-humane actors, without a fixed understanding of who or what is made vulnerable, or what they are made vulnerable to (physical, economic, social, material, or mental damage). Through the presentation of several observed video consultations, I show how video can both facilitate and introduce vulnerability into consultations. I will also present how vulnerability is not always negative in the consultation, as it at times allows for additional care work.

10.7. Caring for Patient Non-attendance: Infrastructural Care Work in Missed Hospital Appointments

Charlotte Nørholm (Hammel Regional Hospital)

Patient non-attendance is a persistent challenge in healthcare with implications for both clinical practice and patient care, including delayed diagnosis, disrupted care pathways and wasted resources. Despite this, little is known about how staff experience and handle missed appointments in clinical practice. Drawing on ethnographic fieldwork in two hospital clinics and interviews with doctors, nurses and medical secretaries, this study examines how staff respond to and manage non-attendance in daily clinical work. The study shows that staff care for patient non-attendance in multiple modes, distributed across patients, colleagues and the healthcare system: 1) Staff care for patients by attending to vulnerabilities that may underpin missed appointments, tinkering with schedules, communication and routines to support them. 2) Staff care for colleagues by treating non-attendance as moments of breathing space in a pressured healthcare environment and protecting them from excess workload. 3) Staff care for the healthcare system by discontinuing patients with repeated non-attendance to prevent wasted resources and ensure timely access for other patients. By attending to patient non-attendance as a site of infrastructural care work, the study argues that handling non-attendance is not merely an operational task but a form of situated, relational and distributed care work that is enacted across sociotechnical arrangements, in which different modes of care are valued and prioritized.

10.8. The Beast and the Black Hole: Ambiguous Data Experiences of Vulnerable Data Infrastructures in Danish Nursing Home Care

Mie Winther Christensen (Roskilde University)

Digital documentation in Danish eldercare has become a contested political issue in recent years. In this paper, we argue that the data work undertaken by care professionals in nursing homes is shaped by a series of data paradoxes (Høyer, 2021). On the one hand, care professionals are subject to ongoing reforms aimed at reducing the amount of digital documentation required in their everyday practices. On the other hand, they are continuously confronted with new initiatives from local governing and administrative bodies that depend on them to produce new volumes of digitally documented data. Drawing on ethnographic material from three nursing homes in Copenhagen, we explore care professionals' experiences with data and their perceptions of the vulnerabilities embedded within the data infrastructures they both produce and rely upon in their professional work. Our analysis shows that documentation work in nursing homes is far from a neutral or objective praxis. Rather, it involves human work, relationships, and emotions, as the data recorded in digital systems represent the lived realities of elderly residents. We conclude that, in the act of documentation, care professionals engage in ongoing ethics work (Banks, 2016; Kamp, 2025), navigating these data paradoxes with a heightened awareness of 'doing the right thing' as the digital data they produce may have direct consequences for subsequent care practices and the possible last period of life for the residents.

10.9. Virtual Reality Therapy and Epistemic and Infrastructural (Re)configurations within Psychiatry

Bianca Jansky (University of Copenhagen)

Amidst rapid technological innovation and a widely recognized mental health crisis, psychiatry has increasingly become a site of digital experimentation. Virtual Reality Therapy (VRT) is one such emerging intervention, promoted as a low-risk and personalized treatment option, particularly for persistent mental health conditions. Based on ongoing empirical research following the movement of VRT within schizophrenia care from research settings into clinical practice in Denmark, I explore how VRT contributes to epistemic and infrastructural reconfigurations within psychiatry. VRT extends the therapeutic relation from a triad of patient, therapist, and communication technology (Zeavin 2021) to therapeutic multiplicity of patient, therapist, communication technology, digital interface, immersive environments, digital representation of auditory hallucination, and the actual auditory hallucination. In doing so, it reshapes how distress is understood and addressed through technological mediation. At the same time, VR's implementation makes the materiality of care and its infrastructural dependencies visible and foreground epistemic shifts in how mental health conditions are understood and placed in relation to each other, through technological devices. VRT not only reorganizes psychiatric knowledge and practice, but also introduces new vulnerabilities related to access, and technical maintenance under which digital care becomes possible.

11

Infrastructures of Feelings: How Emotions, Senses, and Affects Create, Maintain and Disrupt Infrastructures

Sofia Sif Overby Fjorback, **Ida Kirk Haumann**, **Louise Folker Christensen & Line Steen Bygballe** (University of Copenhagen)

This panel examines and discusses the roles of emotions and senses in creating, maintaining, repairing, and disrupting infrastructures and thus how they engage in infrastructuring practices. It includes papers that present contemporary cases, discuss theoretical concepts and/or contribute with methodological reflections from fields such as, but not exclusively, medical STS/humanities, migration studies, environmental studies, and digital studies.

Within STS and related fields of study there has been a lengthy debate about different definitions of emotions, feelings, and affects (Ahmed 2004; Thrift 2008; Wetherell 2012), often marked by recurring conceptual distinctions and tensions. In this panel we wish to look beyond these distinctions in order to investigate and understand the roles of emotions and feelings in contemporary empirical studies and theoretical conceptualizations of infrastructures. By doing so, we aim to open new avenues of discussing the enactments of the socio-material, distributed, sensory, and collective qualities of emotions, feelings, and affect.

We are interested in discussions on how shared emotional norms and practices shape infrastructures (and vice versa), how infrastructures of feelings reconfigure different types of agency and affordances, as well as how emotions make specific geographies and temporalities emerge and take shape. By foregrounding emotions, senses, and affect as infrastructural processes rather than epiphenomena, the panel contributes to ongoing STS debates on how infrastructures are lived, felt, and sustained in practice.

11.1. Rational Emotionality as a Feeling Rule: Professional Socialization in Biomedical Research Groups

Elina I. Mäkinen (Tampere University)

Professional socialization research shows how newcomers to professional groups learn values, norms, and skills through mentorship, storytelling, and rites of passage. Yet we know little about how shared emotional norms and feeling rules are produced as part of professional socialization. This is particularly important in contexts, where newcomers engage in works tasks that are associated with moral and emotional taint. Drawing on scholarship on emotional dirty work, this paper examines biomedical research groups where junior scientists must learn how to conduct scientific experiments with laboratory animals, including killing them. Based on semi-structured interviews with biomedical researchers across career stages, I analyze rational emotionality (Michael & Birke, 1994) as a feeling rule that structures everyday work practice. The findings reveal the ways in which junior scientists are guided towards rational emotionality and how they make sense of these socialization experiences. While research groups socialize newcomers into the technical demands of emotionally charged work—the procedures for conducting experiments with and ultimately killing the animals—they struggle to socialize newcomers into the emotional dimensions of that work. As a feeling rule, rational emotionality prescribes emotional restraint and closes off opportunities for acknowledging or working through emotions caused by morally and emotionally tainted tasks.

11.2. Tactful Touch – Tactful Knowledge?

Sofia Sif Overby Fjorback (University of Copenhagen)

What happens when people touch each other and what meaning does touch have in everyday lives and professional practices? This paper explores how touch operates as an infrastructure of feelings in professional care practices where a tactful knowledge – a bodily and professional judgement – emerges through sensory and affective encounters between practitioners and patients. Based on qualitative interviews with physiotherapists and foot therapists, the analysis investigates how practitioners learn when to intervene and when to hold back, and how knowledge becomes situated in the hands through sensing resistance, pain, and vulnerability. Rather than treating touch as a purely interpersonal act, the paper conceptualizes tactile practices as part of distributed socio-material infrastructures. Through touch, practitioners coordinate care, negotiate boundaries, and sustain relations of trust, recognition, and responsibility. These affective and sensory dynamics contribute to maintaining everyday care infrastructures, while also revealing moments of uncertainty where emotional attunement becomes crucial. Drawing on theories of situated and embodied knowledge (Ahmed 2006: Haraway 1988), the paper argues that tactile judgement is relational, ethical, and context-dependent. Although technology and documentation systems are increasingly central to professional practice, they cannot replace the sensory and affective competencies developed through embodied engagement – instead they coexist.

11.3. Emotional Infrastructures for Pain: Affective Computing and the Datafication of Chronicity

Amelie Lange (Technical University of Denmark)

The interdisciplinary research field of automated pain assessment (APA) seeks to render pain computable through biometric proxies such as facial expression, movement, and physiological signals. Yet pain poses a persistent epistemic dilemma: it lacks a stable ground truth and remains anchored in subjective report. Drawing on ongoing fieldwork in APA settings, this paper examines how this challenge, particularly in relation to chronicity, is managed in scientific practice (Knorr-Cetina 1999). One prominent approach to APA is affective computing (Picard 1997), where pain is modelled via affective and behavioural expressions such as discomfort or guarded movement. Tracing a chronic pain dataset and its experimental protocols in action, the paper examines how lab practices incorporate lived and clinical experiences of pain via affect, using affective expressions to link situated moments of pain to broader chronic trajectories. In doing so, they mediate between fluctuating temporalities and bounded experimental time (Hussey & Douglas-Jones 2024); pain's subjectivity is redistributed in affective form across datasets, labels, and sensing practices (Bowker & Star 1999). Affective computing infrastructures stabilise the conditions under which pain can be rendered computationally tractable. The mobilisation of feeling sustains the project of computing pain under conditions of epistemic strain, making pain knowable through its affective expressions where it otherwise resists capture.

11.4. Doing Tacit Suffering

Marie Gorm Aabo, Louise Folkver & Astrid Jespersen (Unievrsity of Copenhagen)

Inspired by 'tacit knowledge' (Polanyi 1967) and theories on 'suffering' (Das 1997; Han 2013; Kleinman et al. 1994) this paper explores the processes of making suffering tacit, exemplified by the chronic condition tinnitus. We present three kinds of arrangements that enable tinnitus to become tacit. Our argument is that these arrangements are a constant navigation between 'critical moments' and the routines of everyday life, with the aim of dampening, soothing and minimising the omnipresent symptoms of tinnitus. Drawing on ethnographic interviews and participants observations with 30 people living with tinnitus in Denmark, the paper examines three intertwined arrangements: temporally, as ongoing adjustments unfold over time; emotionally, through continuous dampening of affective responses; and relationally, in a shifting interplay between individual efforts and collective, socio-material practices. These arrangements involve subtle adjustments of attention, routines, and environments in order to stabilise fluctuating experiences of suffering. By conceptualising tacit suffering, the paper contributes to discussions of infrastructures of feeling by showing how emotional, temporal, and socio-material orderings are continuously practiced to render tinnitus liveable. The paper thus approaches tacitness by attending to how affect, emotion, and sensation are socio-materially entangled. The paper also makes a critical contribution to concepts such as coping and habituation.

11.5. From Crane to Office: Affective Infrastructures and the Reconfiguration of the Working Body in Maritime Logistics

Sophia Leipert (Goethe University Frankfurt)

Each year, around eight million containers pass through the Port of Hamburg, where automation is increasingly reshaping logistical infrastructure. Since the opening of the Container Terminal Altenwerder in 2002, Hamburg has become a pioneer of terminal automation. Yet key operations remain dependent on port workers whose embodied skills stabilise semi-automated systems. In this presentation, I examine automation through the lens of "infrastructures of feelings", focusing on how affect, senses, and emotions are mobilised by different port stakeholders in reconfiguring the working body of port workers. Drawing on field visits and (expert) interviews with a focus on human-machine interactions, I analyse how workers are prepared for automated environments through simulation-based training, gamified tasks, and, relatedly, processes of affective (re)alignment: Putting automation into practice relies on corporal reconfigurations and the cultivation of attention, anticipation and attunement in changing work environments. These processes both sustain existing sociotechnical assemblages and generate new tensions, as workers must navigate uncertainty and shifting means of control amid consolidating power hierarchies. At the same time, automation never evolves without friction. By conceptualising affect as infrastructural, my presentation contributes to debates on how infrastructures are lived and maintained, and how they reshape spatial and temporal conditions of work.

11.6. Objects of Hope: A Sensory Ethnography of Hope in Cancer Rehabilitation

Maria Mieskiewicz Larsen (University of Southern Denmark)

This study, part of the project Hope and Agency, examines how hope takes shape among people living with cancer in rehabilitation contexts. Ethnographic fieldwork shows how hopelessness operates as a constitutive premise, reflecting Mattingly's (2010) paradox of hope. Drawing on Mattingly and sensory ethnography inspired by Pink (2015), I approach hope as a tacit, embodied, and sensorial phenomenon emerging through atmospheres, practices, materialities, and interactions rather than through discourse alone. Engaging Graven & Olsen's (2018) idea of "spaces of hope," I explore how individuals orient affectively and sensorially as feeling, sensing beings. Building on Ahmed's (2004) notion of emotional "stickiness," I trace how medical, goal-oriented, and existential forms of hope adhere to particular bodies, professions, practices, and objects. Hope and hopelessness are thus understood as affective conditions embedded in social and material infrastructures rather than as personal traits. The study advances sensory ethnography as a methodological lens for examining hope as practiced and relational. Attending to my own embodied responses highlights how researchers co-produce affective atmospheres. Finally, I consider how rehabilitation settings might sustain multiple, coexisting hopes and how practitioners and researchers can inhabit spaces of despair without defaulting to consolation or resolution.

11.7. Infrastructures of Feelings in the Danish Cancer Cause

Line Steen Bygballe (University of Copenhagen)

This paper examines how emotions function as infrastructures in the making of the Danish cancer cause as a long-term civic and health movement (Star & Ruhleder, 1996; Star, 1999; Ahmed, 2004). Based on ongoing ethnographic fieldwork, archival research, and interviews conducted in the project "Kræftsagen som Folkesag", the paper explores how hope, fear, care, and solidarity are key elements in building and maintaining a strong Danish cancer movement over time (Hochschild, 1983; Polletta & Jasper, 2001). Rather than treating emotions as individual experiences, the paper approaches them as distributed and socio-material processes that shape fundraising campaigns, patient support practices, public awareness work, and volunteer engagement (Ahmed, 2004; Wetherell, 2012). From early radium fundraising campaigns in the 1920s to contemporary patient counselling centres and national volunteer events such as “Lyserød Lørdag” and “Stafet for Livet”, the cancer cause emerges as an infrastructure of feelings in which a shared emotional opposition to cancer as a common enemy helps produce and sustain a strong collective movement over time (Goodwin, Jasper, & Polletta, 2001; Ahmed, 2010). Methodologically, it reflects on how historical sources, interviews, and ethnographic participation can be used to study emotions not as private states but as historically situated and collectively enacted practices (Pink, 2009; Wetherell, 2012).

11.8. The Birth of a Miracle: The Work of Affective Narrative Techniques in Grounding the Uterus Transplantation Field

Alexandra Middleton, Zainab Afshan Sheikh, Anja Marie Bornø Jensen
(University of Copenhagen)

Medical conferences are not only sites of communicating study data and establishing clinical best practices; they are also social arenas where expectations, hopes, and shared visions are performed and legitimized. In the emerging field of uterus transplantation, at the intersection of reproductive technology and organ transplantation, international gatherings become a key zone of consolidating the technology's disparate community and performing the social and ethical coherence of a field at a critical inflection point from experimental trials to clinical practice. Drawing upon interviews with medical experts and conference ethnography conducted in Sweden, Turkey, and Denmark, this paper examines the myriad emotional registers present, explicitly and tacitly, in these arenas: celebration to skepticism, exaltation to hesitation, quasi-religious miracle to clinical fear. These registers are mobilized through metaphors, narrative forms, ritualization, aesthetic performance, and dramaturgy. Conceptualizing these as affective narrative techniques, we explore how the performance of emotion through narrative not only reflects but actively creates healthcare infrastructures, establishing experimental technologies as medical fields while managing challenges from within. We consider the emotional practices that bring into being the social life and narrative identity of an emerging field among its practitioners.

11.9. The Sound of Wear: Speculative Sensibility in Microplastic Atmospheres

Neylan Ogutveren Aular (University of Turku)

Across the Nordics, electric vehicles signal ecological progress while leaving the tire-road interface intact. Every turn of every wheel abrades rubber against asphalt, releasing particles that constitute one of the largest sources of microplastics in urban environments, entering air, water, and soil through pathways that remain largely invisible within current environmental governance.

This paper argues that the traffic hum is a microplastic event, and that the body listening to it is already inside the waste it is trying to know. Speculative sonic fieldwork conducted at Turku's bridges, intersections, and arterial roads, across rain, snow, and dry cold, cultivates a sensibility toward the atmospheric, continuous, and affective dimensions of tire wear that measurement brackets out. Sound is intra-active. Vibration, matter, and perception unfold together, and the sensor and the microphone register the same atmospheric condition from different positions, one as emission data, the other as affective texture.

The paper situates itself between waste studies and landscape studies, challenging the ocularcentric inheritance through which mobility infrastructures are known and governed. To hear the traffic hum as waste is to refigure the sensory and political terms by which microplastic futures are imagined, including whose bodies, human and non-human, absorb what the green transition leaves unaddressed.

11.10. Allergic Infrastructuring: Navigating Contested Environmental Prescriptions to Urban Pollen Allergies

Stig Bo Andersen (University of Copenhagen)

Urban areas are becoming greener, and pollen allergies are on the rise. Drawing on an ethnographic study of everyday life with pollen allergies in Copenhagen, this paper explores the infrastructures of pollen mobilities in green urban areas, asking how allergenic plants, either ruderal, domesticated, or spontaneous, affect allergic urban dwellers. While the normative medical advice is to reduce exposure, which is dominant in allergy-friendly movements in urban planning, the biodiversity hypothesis within allergology argues that a lack of exposure to (bio)diverse environments are a factor to the rise of allergies. In this light, exposure is a contested environmental prescription of either avoidance or tolerance regimes that diversely accentuate the co-constituting effects of urban environments on the human immune system. Taking the question of exposure as point of departure, this paper argues that navigating everyday life with pollen allergies relies on practices of allergic infrastructuring. Mitigating symptoms becomes a choreography of allergic sensing and idiosyncratic experience to maintain everyday life in the disruptive seasonality of pollen. Pollen allergies are worsening due to climate change and air pollution, and pollen seasons are becoming longer. This paper contributes an everyday life perspective on how human-pollen allergic experiences reorganize movement, respond to seasonality, and renegotiate routines as practices of allergic infrastructuring.

12

Mapping the Field: AI in Clinical Practice

Asbjørn Malte Pedersen (AU), **Kalle Kusk** (AU), **Rikke Torenholt** (Danish Cancer Institute), **Victor Vadmand Jensen** (AU & Silkeborg Regional Hospital), **Mie S. Dam** (UCPH), **Iben M. Gjødsbøl** (UCPH), **Dorthe Brogård Kristensen** (SDU), **Claus Bossen** (AU), **Mette Terp Høybye** (AU & Silkeborg Regional Hospital)

This panel critically engages with artificial intelligence (AI) in clinical practice and the tension between its promissory futures and mundane frictions. AI is often positioned as a remedy for healthcare challenges: enhancing precision in diagnosis and treatment to reduce uncertainty and variation in quality, while also promising to alleviate capacity constraints and shorten waiting times. Despite this current hype, emerging studies foreground the challenges of translating these promises into practice and the frictions that arise in doing so. Ethics and responsibility are central to this discussion and cannot be reduced to mere abstract principles or external constraints; it is discursive work through which practitioners legitimize action, distribute responsibility, and stabilize promissory futures. Meanwhile, AI reshapes what counts as good data and as epistemic subjects, and how accountability is claimed, creating ethical disruption by reconfiguring practice.

Following this, we are interested in how ethical arguments and decisions are constructed in situated practices: who "owns", and who is subject to, a decision when AI participates? And how is accountability, auditability, and explainability enacted across and between clinicians, vendors, managers, and infrastructure?

Another central discussion concerns labor. Rather than treating AI as simply replacing labor, a key issue is how AI reshapes workflows and who benefits from these changes. Along these lines, we are interested in how professions, tasks, and clinician-patient relationships are reconfigured through the deployment and use of AI. In particular, we ask how expertise is produced and negotiated in AI projects: for example, which forms of knowledge (clinical, data-related, organizational) become authoritative, and how do new intermediary roles emerge?

Despite the often-claimed urgency around healthcare AI, delivering AI in practice and achieving the expected outcomes has proven more demanding than demonstrating algorithmic capability and accuracy. We therefore welcome studies that engage with implementation as sociotechnical integration: moving from proof-of-concept to operation involves procurement and vendor relations, governance arrangements, integration with electronic health records, and data security requirements, often revealing that "making AI work" is as much an organizational and infrastructural project as it is a technical one.

12.1. Beyond the Error: Frictions in Healthcare Professionals' Repair of AI Systems

Victor Vadmand Jensen (Aarhus University & Silkeborg Regional Hospital)**, Astrid Meyer** (Aarhus University)**, Mette Terp Høybye** (Aarhus University & Silkeborg Regional Hospital) **& Rikke Hagensby Jensen** (Aarhus University)

Artificial intelligence (AI) systems in healthcare are prone to errors and inaccuracies, necessitating healthcare professionals (HCPs) to attend to AI systems and repair their errors based on clinical expertise. Yet we lack knowledge of the burdens imposed by repair work on HCPs, limiting decision-makers' options for supporting HCPs during disruptive moments of AI repair as embedded in care practices. To bridge this gap, we build on ethnographic fieldwork in a Danish hospital ward using AI to monitor geriatric patients' movements. We used participant observation and interviews to investigate how the AI's errors created frictions that both generated visions of good repair work and impeded that very same repair. We identified three types of repair work. First, identifying errors generated knowledge of staff and patient whereabouts but was made difficult by cumbersome AI-embedding devices. Second, correcting errors animated HCPs to engage with error sources yet was challenged by patient flow and organization limiting when errors can be corrected. Third, communicating errors fostered visions of learning and AI improvement which were impeded by perceived lack of changes in AI performance. This shows repair of healthcare AI as beyond the individual error, intertwined with HCPs' expertise, ward conditions, and institutionalized integration of AI. Meaningful repair work requires both staff-level coordination and systemic responsibility allocation for error management and follow-up.

12.2. Emerging Configurations When AI Screens for Cancer

Kalle Kusk, Asbjørn Malte Pedersen & Claus Bossen (Aarhus University)

This paper presents findings from an ongoing investigation of AI implementation in mammography screening in Denmark. In three of five regions, now employs AI for the reading of mammograms, a job typically undertaken by a radiologist. By early 2027 AI is expected to be out in all five regions. Recent national clinical guidelines present AI as a technology with the potential to correctly identify a proportion of cancer-free women while substantially reducing screening workload, fewer false positives, and a higher detection rate. The paper draws on observations, interviews, and document analysis. Analytically, we build on sociology of standards (Lampland & Star, 2008) along with concepts such as interpretive flexibility and stabilization (Bijker, 2015), to examine how AI implementation unfolds as continuous and localized processes of negotiation rather than uniform one-time deployments. We trace the system's expansion from the first regional implementation to the other regions and the challenges encountered: We argue that AI implementation in healthcare is best understood as stabilization work, in which systems are continually maintained, adjusted, and renegotiated across research, organizational contexts, and clinical practice.

12.3. From Proof-of-Concept to Practice: Tracing the Sociotechnical Labor of AI Integration Across Hospital Sites

Maria Bach Nielsen (Aalborg University)

Drawing on longitudinal engagement (2020-2026) combining professional implementation and industrial PhD research across three Danish hospital sites and additional stroke centers, this contribution traces how trust, accountability, and expertise are negotiated during pilot-phase integration of AI-based decision support in routine brain MRI and acute stroke imaging. Three conditions may enable or hinder trust and adoption. First, accountability must be enacted through practice, distributed across radiographers, radiologists, neurologists, and institutional actors. When responsibility chains remain unclear, AI remains consulted but not trusted, regardless of algorithmic performance. Second, workflow fit proves inseparable from material infrastructures: access friction, display ecologies, and tempo alignment determine whether systems become embedded or abandoned. Third, sustained adoption depends on ongoing care work largely invisible in evaluation metrics: multi-hierarchy ambassadors, debrief cadences, and governance arrangements that constitute organizational labor rarely accounted for in implementation frameworks. The contribution centers on rendering visible the infrastructuring work that sustains clinical AI, and on examining how vendor-hospital relations, procurement constraints, and existing EHR architectures shape what adoption becomes possible.

12.4. When Artificial Intelligence Encounters Healthcare Infrastructures

Claus Bossen, Asbjørn M. Pedersen & Kalle Kusk (Aarhus University)

The implementation of artificial intelligence (AI) into healthcare has turned out to be challenging. That the challenges are socio-technical has been concluded by several studies (e.g. Gyldenkærne et al, 2025; Nair et al 2025; Zajac et al 2023) and is almost a trivial statement. Thus, a closer look at the socio-technical state of affairs is required and this presentation will discuss these in two ways: First, through a literature-based exploration of the implementation challenges, where we identified 100+ factors and five ways of framing the process. Second, through examples of these challenges in specific cases of AI integration. The aim is to understand why there are relatively few examples of AI becoming part of clinical practices in Denmark as well as internationally, despite AI being loudly hyped as a way to improve diagnostics and treatment, save time and resources, reduce workload and more. One explanation, of course, is that the success of AI for producing text is misleading, the stakes are different between producing text and making screenings for diseases, making diagnostics and treating illness (e.g. predicting sepsis og post-operative complications). However, the question is which concepts and approaches would be relevant and fruitful to apply in analyses of AI implementations that we already know are sociotechnical.

12.5. Between Humility and Hype: Diverging Beliefs about What Predictive Psychological AI Can Solve in Mental Health

Jonas Yurtsever Vesterdal (Aalborg University)

Emerging efforts to develop AI for mental health are accompanied by contrasting expectations among involved actors. Interview and fieldnote data from my PhD project show that researchers developing predictive models in psychology and psychiatry - conceptualised as Predictive Psychological AI (PPAI) (Vesterdal, 2025, in review) - emphasise epistemic humility, data limitations, and the contextual fragility of algorithmic outputs. In contrast, more peripheral actors, including policy stakeholders, organisational leaders, and researchers outside PPAI development, articulate far more optimistic visions of AI's capacity to address mental health challenges. Using sociotechnical imaginaries (Jasanoff & Kim, 2015) and the sociology of expectations (Borup et al., 2006), I examine how different positions within the innovation system shape divergent orientations toward the future of AI. Drawing on Fitzgerald's (2017) work on affective labour in neuroscience, I also analyse the function of the schism between humility and hype, considering whether developers' humility functions as a strategic way of pre empting critique and protecting scientific credibility. The analysis contributes to STS debates by showing how affective and positional dynamics structure expectations and credibility practices in emerging AI-for mental health fields.

12.6. (Non)problematizing Patient Non-attendance: Staff Attitudes Towards Predictive Modelling for Missed Hospital Appointments

Charlotte Nørholm (Hammel Regional Hospital)

Patient non-attendance is widely framed as a healthcare problem, linked to prolonged waiting times, inefficient resource allocation, and disrupted care pathways. Predictive modelling is promoted as a promising solution to reduce non-attendance, yet little is known about how such technologies would be received by the staff expected to engage with them. Drawing on ethnographic fieldwork and interviews with physicians, nurses, and medical secretaries in two hospital departments, this study explores staff attitudes towards a predictive model for patient non-attendance. The study shows that staff understand non-attendance as a non-problem. Although problematized from organizational and political perspectives, missed appointments are not experienced as a substantial issue in clinical practice. While notices of cancellation require coordination work, non-attendance demands no pre-action because it cannot be anticipated. A predictive model would reconfigure non-attendance and transform it from a non-actionable phenomenon into an actionable problem, bringing about new responsibilities, ethical dilemmas, and coordination tasks that may exacerbate existing workload pressures. The study highlights a misalignment between the promissory futures of AI technologies and the lived realities of clinical work, showing how attempts to use AI to solve system-level problems may inadvertently enact new problem spaces in contexts where the underlying issue holds limited practical meaning for staff.

12.7. Predictive Algorithms in General Practice

Eva Graae Krause & Mie Seest Dam (University of Copenhagen)

AI-driven personal risk prediction tools are expected to have a profound impact within the field of primary cancer care, strengthening early diagnostics and enabling precision prevention and more efficient allocation of healthcare resources. While current research on predictive algorithms has primarily focused on performance metrics, little is known about how they can translate into clinical practice. How will GPs interpret and use personal algorithmic cancer predictions? How will patients experience and handle the potential distress of knowing their personal cancer risk? How are predictive AI tools regulated to improve cancer care without introducing new biases and harms? To address these questions, we employ the AI-powered decision-support tool, 'Suspicion of Hidden Cancer,' which predicts individual patients' cancer risk from routine blood tests, as an ethnographic case to explore how AI and algorithms are used, embraced, and contested in practice by GPs, patients, and regulative bodies. Combining anthropological studies of the relationship between time and personhood with Science and Technology Studies and Critical Data Studies on the governmental and societal effects of AI-enabled algorithms, this paper demonstrates how AI-driven cancer precision prevention guides both medical and organizational decisions, simultaneously shaping professional practices, patient experiences, and the delivery of cancer care.

12.8. Almost Ready to Go Live: Turf Wars, Infrastructural Barriers, and Unpredictability in Clinical AI-based Predictions of Sepsis and Organ Failure

Asbjørn Malte Pedersen; Kalle Kusk & Claus Bossen (Aarhus University)

This paper reports findings from ongoing research on the development of an AI-based application for identify-ing patients at risk of sepsis and organ failure. The study responds to the call to identify and understand the challenges of clinical AI integration. The study is based on interviews with stakeholders, meeting observations, and document research to unfold "the imagined future, unstable present, and structured past" (Vepřek and Carlson, 2026). The project has been on the verge of "going live" as a trial implementation in clinical practice at three different hospital departments for several years. Retrospectively, we follow the project team's challeng-ing and winding work to reach this critical stage of the project: gaining access to real-time data from the region-al EHR, developing the algorithm, obtaining needed devices, fine-tuning the volume of notifications, engaging the clinicians, and overcoming uncertainties. The analysis unfolds this process, and the important roles that project members, private vendors, the healthcare organization, and science play in bringing the AI solution into being. Drawing on an infrastructure perspective, we conceptualize these so-called barriers as 'infrastruc-tural frictions' (e.g., Edwards, 2019) to start discussing how we can understand organizational turf wars, insti-tutional boundaries, and infrastructural ownership as trading zones that necessitate new hybrid roles and co-operations.

12.9. Between Innovation and Regulation: The Epistemic Ethics of Predictive Algorithms in Clinical Practice

Iben Mundbjerg Gjødsbøl & Mie Seest Dam (University of Copenhagen)

Predictive algorithms promise to improve clinical decision-making and enhance the efficiency of healthcare delivery. However, the EU AI Act classifies many such applications as high-risk, subjecting them to extensive regulatory oversight. In 2023, the European Commission's Medical Device Coordination Group issued guidance allowing hospitals to manufacture and use medical devices—including AI-based tools—on a non-industrial scale within the same legal entity, exempting these "in-house" devices from the requirements set out in the Medical Device Regulation. Drawing on qualitative interviews with regional employees approving AI-based tools and with clinicians working with a predictive algorithm, this paper explores the ethical tensions emerging when predictive tools are deployed under the in-house provision. We show that regional employees orient toward compliance with data protection and privacy legislation to avoid public controversies around data misuse. This compliance-driven focus, we argue, risks sidelining broader debates about the epistemic ethics of predictive algorithms: the clinical practices they foster, the knowledge they produce, and the purposes this knowledge can legitimately serve. In the absence of institutional spaces for ethical deliberation, employees may resort to collective ignorance, avoiding involvement with predictive tools they suspect could enable ethically problematic practices such as the deprioritization of patients at the margins of life.

13

Social Work and STS

Peter Danholt, **Mikkel Rask Pedersen**, **Patrick Heiberg Kapsch & Peter Lauritsen** (Aarhus University)

Many STS studies are rooted in empirical studies of practices and in the premise that we must follow, learn and think with the practices we study. Moreover, practices are always more complex, multiple or sophisticated than what theoretical abstractions of them suggest. But STS in return also enables or invites us to think differently about practices. For instance, based on actor network theory, scientific practices become processes through which human and non-human agency is produced through associations. Or as Mol has pointed out, different medical practices enact different versions of a given disease. STS has convincingly shown how knowledge and agency is performed and thus constructed in and through practices and as such STS is instrumental in animating an animistic ontology. Our STS tools and concepts are intrinsic parts of our knowledge production.

Recently, the interest in social work has been growing in STS both nationally and internationally, especially with the extensive digitization of social work. Concerns about how digitization and AI intervene in and change social work are of crucial importance.

This panel includes papers that research social work practices or related fields with STS. Presentations that seek to apply STS concepts and theories to social work to test and develop novel insights of social work. The panel aims to learn with social work through and via methods and concepts from STS and thereby think and experiment with social work through STS.

Examples could be:

- The sociotechnical systems and infrastructures of social work and care.
- Social work as delegating, translating and co-producing of agency.
- Social work as trials of strengths and fact-building.
- Social work as matters of concern and care.
- The programs and anti-programs of digital social work systems.

13.1. The Warm Hands of Digitalization: Digital Care Work in Danish Municipalities

Ina Bækgaard (Technical University of Denmark)

Despite political ambitions of efficiency, the digitalized Danish welfare state is far from self-sustaining, but relies on extensive support work to function in practice. This presentation examines digital care work in Danish municipalities as a central part of social work practice. Based on interviews with employees across health, care, and social sectors, the concept of digital care work is developed to capture the support provided to digitally vulnerable citizens. The analysis shows that this type of support differs from more episodic, task-oriented assistance by being ongoing, relational, and closely intertwined with other care practices. At the same time, the analysis demonstrates that digital care work is not confined to specialized functions such as citizen service centers or libraries. Rather, it forms a structurally embedded part of municipal welfare provision, constituting, repairing, and maintaining the digital infrastructures of the welfare state. This allows for an understanding of digital care work as a matter of care and highlights a fundamental paradox of public sector digitalization: ambitions for efficiency are accompanied by substantial, yet overlooked, additional work. The presentation thus offers a counter-narrative to the dominant political accounts of digitalization's efficiency gains, instead presenting a welfare state where digitalization is warmed by human hands.

13.2. Valuation Work, Tech Work, and Social Work: Constructing AI Tools and Organizational Value Together in a Social Work NGO

Marie Leth Meilvang (University College Lillebaelt)

Digital manager: And then it was kind of like revisiting everything. I mean, the benefits and what are the actual success criteria for us to think this is good enough? How do they use it? And how should they use it? We thought we just had to revisit that again. Interviewer: So [you asked yourself], why? Digital manager: Yes, why? (laughs)

In this presentation, we look at the "why" of an AI developing project in a large, Danish social work NGO. The development project was an AI tool called AICA that would help voluntary counsellors with their written, online counselling with children and youth in an anonymous helpline. Drawing on a qualitative case study of the development, we analyze the valuation work of the organization in relation to the AI tool. We draw on the literature on infrastructural breakdowns (Star, 1999; Graham & Thrift, 2007), visible/invisible work (Star & Strauss, 1999) and valuation (Heuts & Mol, 2013) to show how the development and value of AICA is linked to making specific social work practices visible or invisible. We show how the value and purpose of the technology changes gradually, over time, together with the changes in the technology and technology use.

13.3. Making Data Matter: Infrastructures of Data Collaboration and Care in Social Work

Mikkel Rask Pedersen (Aarhus University)

Social work in child and family welfare services increasingly relies on data to support decision-making about children's wellbeing, with digital case systems shaping how data work is organized over the course of a case. Based on ethnographic fieldwork in Danish municipal services, this paper examines how such data work unfolds in practice. It conceptualizes social workers' data work as infrastructures of data collaboration through which information is sorted, connected, and made meaningful to make statutory obligations, digital infrastructures, and relational commitments such as integrity and respect toward citizens collaborate. In this process, a case does not reach a conclusion, or objective insights for that matter, as a result of the accumulation, quantity, or quality of data itself, but rather from trying out different configurations between data and these commitments until a configuration of relations emerge as stronger than the other. The paper uses these insights to discuss how data work cannot be untied from the ethico-political situation it helps address - here the statutory obligation to care for children's wellbeing - and how this entails working with multiple, sometimes competing lines of care and commitments. This points to the importance of attending data work to understand how decisions rely on more than data itself, requiring engagement with the relations and collaborations through which data come to matter.

13.4. To "speak Well" about Digital Systems and Social Work

Peter Danholt & Peter Lauritsen (Aarhus University)

Digital systems are comprehensive infrastructures in public service in Denmark. Much interaction in state-citizen relations is carried out through digital systems. In the field of social work there exist a body of literature that point out that digital systems are detrimental to social work by producing extensive administrative and bureaucratic burdens leading to multiple detrimental or unintended effects.

Based on the work of Bruno Latour and Isabelle Stengers our contribution here is another. It is concerned with how we cultivate a culture of living and "staying" with digital systems. We offer an empirically based analysis that evince the entangled relations between social work and digital systems. We argue that the 'trouble' they generate, is granted the opportunity to be thought of as consequences of 'good will'. We show that the digital systems are obviously producing work for social workers, which may easily be translated into work and time that 'goes away' from the citizen. But the work produced by the system is rooted in the intention of gaining an in-depth understanding of the life situation of the citizen. In that sense the digital system is (ideally) the manifestation and enabler of social work, not its destroyer. With Stengers we thus intend "to speak well" about the systems; meaning to account for them so that they are provided the opportunity to be realized and thought of with specificity and through their relations.

14

STS Breakdown Studies

Mette Simonsen Abildgaard, Kira Elise Apten Tilcock, Kîsta Bianco Kjær, Laura Kocksch (Aalborg University)

This panel proposes a new strand within STS infrastructure studies, tentatively named Breakdown Studies. While STS has long examined spectacular disasters in physical infrastructures (e.g. Pinch 1991, Fortun 2001) and theorized post-disaster negotiations (Fortun & Frickel 2013), digital breakdowns are more common and less contained by time and space. Digital breakdowns stay hidden, leak, emerge slowly, and persist. Our proposal for STS breakdown studies aims to explore this leakage, rupture and loss as mundane parts of digital infrastructures. Loss and rupture are not exceptions, but fundamental structures of digitization (Thylstrup 2024). When digital breakdowns are not overcome, they become part of fragile computing practices and life with good enough infrastructure (Kocksch 2024). By studying digital breakdowns through the lens of mundanity, waiting, or as non-events, the 'heroes' fixing breakdowns emerge uneasily, or never at all. Instead, mundane breakdowns are handled in a variety of ways from tinkering and counter-archiving, to negotiating expert advice and workarounds. This does not make them less difficult, painful, or fatal. Considering this, breakdown studies also invite 'hope' as a phenomenon (Jackson 2023, Miyazaki 2004), which shapes how we approach or care for loss and disruption, and adds a sense of certainty in how we approach fragile systems. Rather than celebrating resilience, innovation, or restoration, we argue for attending to loss, latency, partial repair, workarounds, and the politics of inaction, by calling for STS to stay with the digital breakdown.

Drawing on our research on disruption and cyber-attacks in Nordic and Arctic digital infrastructures as initial cases, we invite to a collective development of this agenda. The session organizes a discussion around:

- Fields of breakdown studies: communities, authorities, middle managers, digital traces.
- Methodological challenges: ethnographers as spies, handling concealment and anonymity (especially in small state research), studying shameful practices such as doing nothing or something wrong in the face of breakdown, capturing mundane breakdowns through digital methods.
- Conceptual tensions: disturbing hero and villain tales, avoiding easy stories including moralizing good/bad infrastructure, conceptualizing fragility and tensions in fluid technologies.

15

Energy Infrastructuring: Which 'networks of Power' Do We Encounter?

Daniel Nordstrand Frantzen, **Julia Kirch Kirkegaard & Tom Cronin**
(Technical University of Denmark)

The energy transition has been a key agenda within Denmark and the European Union for several years but has been supported through rapidly shifting justifications. Whereas the transition was initially heralded for its green, climatic qualities, the focus has shifted in recent years to its positive effect on European competitiveness (epitomized in the Draghi report) and on energy independence and resilience under the heading of "home-grown energy". These rapid changes demand exploration of what constitutes "good energy" (Kirkegaard, forthcoming) in contemporary societies. This panel endeavors to do that by attending to the energy infrastructures powering our societies: how are they infrastructured? What devices and networks of expertise support them? What values or versions of the good do they support? And what controversies do they evoke?

As highlighted by Thomas P. Hughes (1983), Networks of Power are complex sociotechnical systems which support certain values, cultures, and styles as they gather momentum and become stable. Energy infrastructures, including electricity infrastructures, thus embody a wide range of politics from brute material exclusions (cf. Winner, 1980) to scripted roles (Akrich, 1992), "issuefication" (Marres, 2014) and "valuation struggles" (Pallesen, 2016). Asking "Which 'networks of power' do we encounter?", we invite empirically grounded papers to explore the politics of energy infrastructures and the related question of what constitutes "good energy". Papers explore the making of specific infrastructures for generating, converting, or distributing electricity, as well as the related infrastructural practices of consumption.

1).

15.1. Infrastructuring Electron-molecular Encounters Over Time – The Role of Expertise

Julia Kirch Kirkegaard, Tom Cronin, Daniel Nordstrand Frantzen, Rebekka Nordal Thomsen & Julius Kob (Technical University of Denmark)

The renewed geopolitical turmoil has again launched energy and its infrastructuring into high politics and matters of security. To understand current valuation struggles over what constitutes a resilient and green energy future – epitomized in contestations over envisioned giga-scale energy islands and sector-coupled green hydrogen – we render an account of the de- and re-coupling of green electrons and green hydrogen molecules over time, and their relationship to carbon molecules. Based on document analysis and expert interviews and founded in a relational lens of expertise and valuation, we ask how de- and re-configurations of networks of expertise have rendered the encounter between green electrons from renewable energy and different molecules feasible and valuable. Starting from the late 19th century, we map four moments where different electron-molecule encounters are infrastructured in particular ways, co-produced by actors and their economic and technical tools and devices (e.g. cables, pipelines, funding instruments). We discuss our contributions to the literature by cross-fertilising the sociology of expertise with a lens of valuation studies, which allows us to shed new light on how shifting configurations of expertise have rendered different forms of energy storage – in various electron-molecule encounters – valuable and feasible over time, with implications for what is constituted as a 'green' and 'resilient' energy future.

15.2. Dislocated Translation and Symbolic Compliance: EU Renewable Energy Community Policy in a Hostile Context

Marios Angelos Kalemis (University of Groningen)**, Paul Upham** (University of Groningen) **& Sophie Nyborg** (Technical University of Denmark)

This paper examines how EU Renewable Energy Community (REC) policy translates in Cyprus - the EU's last fully isolated electricity grid, operating under conditions of partial territorial occupation and geopolitical constraints on both gas exploitation and electricity interconnection. These conditions make Cyprus a theoretically productive case for examining what happens when EU climate policy, designed for materially stable and interconnected systems, encounters a peripheral member state where geopolitical and material constraints fundamentally shape implementation. Drawing on Actor-Network Theory's translation framework and the concept of sociotechnical imaginaries, the paper analyses policy documents, semi-structured interviews, and participant observation within Project Phaethon, an EU-funded Centre of Excellence hosting a renewable energy community pilot at the University of Cyprus. The analysis develops two theoretical contributions: 'Dislocated Translation,' which accounts for how policy mobilization fragments when the actor capable of anchoring implementation remains distant from the translation context; and 'productive ambiguity under constraint,' which explores how policy flexibility can enable procedural compliance while substantive transformation remains limited. The paper concludes by proposing a structured REC blueprint for geopolitically and materially constrained member states.

15.3. Contesting the Green - Re-orienting Hydrogen Ambitions "from Green Dreams to Reality"

Rebekka Nordal Thomsen & Julia Kirch Kirkegaard (Technical University of Denmark)

As Europe's hydrogen utopia encounters setbacks, industry actors, experts, and policymakers are reorienting expectations, calling for a shift "from green dreams to reality." In this shift, the framework for qualifying hydrogen as green has become contested. While some industry actors push to loosen criteria for defining renewable or green hydrogen, others promote a color agnostic approach that incorporates "low carbon" blue hydrogen from natural gas with carbon capture. We explore these efforts to (re)qualify the greenness of hydrogen as a valuation struggle, asking which concerns and values are rendered (in)visible and what visions of hydrogen infrastructures they enact. As such, we examine how this valuation struggle configures what counts as "good" hydrogen and, by extension, "good energy" within Europe's transition. Our analysis centers on key documents - the EU delegated act on Renewable Fuels of Non Biological Origins (RFNBO, 2023) and the related Low Carbon Fuels act (2025) - supplemented with ethnographic observations from industry conferences and interviews with developers, experts, NGOs, and regulators to capture how these documents are contested and mobilized. We show how these regulatory devices act both as tools of valuation and tools of infrastructuring: they configure and constrain hydrogen systems and make certain energy futures more legible while potentially blocking alternative pathways in the transition.

15.4. An Infrastructural Palimpsest. the Struggle for Good Energy in Cintegabelle, France

Roxana Bucata (Central European University) **& Stefan Voicu** (CUNY Graduate Center)

In the French village of Cintegabelle, a project to install five wind turbines has been dividing the community for a decade. The village is home to the second corporate floating solar park in France, as well as one of the first citizen-led solar parks built by the Enercoop Midi-Pyrénées cooperative in the region. Cintegabelle also hosts a large corporate-owned solar park and a large private methanisation project. These were all met with critique, but none was as controversial as the wind farm. In this paper, we follow the actors involved in the controversy, highlighting how they activate infrastructures of people, money, and energy to create moral framings that promote or contest the project as good. We use the concept of infrastructural palimpsest to point to the entangled infrastructures in which the turbines are placed, as well as how various actors underwrite, overwrite, or recover them. Set to be built on the Ariège plain, the dispute involved farmers supporting the project, the farmer who agreed on condition that one of the turbines would be owned collectively by residents, and owners of land adjacent to the wind turbines who contested the project altogether because of an anticipated landscape devaluation. We argue that these controversies point to shortcomings in the design of renewable energy projects, which consider in depth the technical aspects while dismissing with ceremonial consultations the infrastructural palimpsest that characterizes project sites.

15.5. Splitting the Tab. Public Perceptions of Global Cost Allocation for Carbon Dioxide Removal

Lucilla Losi (Aarhus University)

Large-scale implementation of carbon dioxide removal is increasingly positioned as a component of contemporary energy transitions. As necessary although resource intensive methods, these raise complex transnational governance and equity challenges, particularly regarding how costs, benefits, and responsibilities should be allocated. These questions are central to debates over what constitutes "good energy" especially since climate mitigation, competitiveness, and energy security are differently prioritized. Yet, public evaluations of competing burden-sharing principles remain underexplored. Drawing on nationally representative surveys from six countries (Brazil, Italy, Malaysia, Norway, Saudi Arabia, and the UK), we analyse how different principles of global cost allocation are evaluated in terms of fairness. Using Latent Class Analysis, we identify three distinct "publics": two characterized by clearly differentiated preferences and a third marked by greater uncertainty. These segments reflect different orientations toward responsibility and obligation within emerging climate and energy infrastructures. Moreover, class membership is systematically associated with ideological orientations and climate-related worldviews across countries. By foregrounding public perceptions of fairness in global cost allocation, the paper contributes to understanding how competing principles of responsibility may shape the legitimacy and political feasibility of future energy infrastructures.

15.6. Site-ing a Substation: From a Multiplicity of Potentialities Towards Necessary Closures

Emil Nissen (Technical University of Denmark)

Electrification is driving major landscape changes, which demand descriptions of the work causing these changes. This paper traces the processes of materializing a substation, which will interconnect offshore wind farms with Denmark and Germany in the 'Energy Island Bornholm' project. Conceptually, we rely on ANT-inspired studies of architecture, which highlight the importance of 'site-ing' which follows movements from a multiplicity of potentialities in the project to relative 'closures' of project design. We fuse this lens with the notion of 'registers of valuing' treating site-ing as a process of valuing – a movement from a multiplicity of possibly conflicting registers of valuing to closures, where it becomes established what forms of value the project conveys. Using this lens, we analyze placing, designing, connecting, and compensating as movements involved in site-ing and valuing the substation on Bornholm. Based on the analysis, we coin the notion of "closure power," pointing to the unequal capacities of actors involved in site-ing to decide which forms of valuing to include or exclude in the final project design. We call for future studies on substations and grid enforcement more broadly, which can contribute to a burgeoning conversation on how electrification and combating anthropogenic climate change affect landscapes

16

DASTS2026 Early-Career Researcher Meetup

Frederik Vejlin (Aarhus University)

By popular demand and building on the success of the inaugural DASTS Early-Career Researcher Workshop at Aarhus University in 2025, we invite you to join the DASTS2026 Early-Career Meetup, organized by the DASTS Early-Career Working Group.

The meetup is an opportunity for PhD students and early-career researchers in the Danish STS community to find out what everyone else is actually working on, meet people from other institutions, and help shape the DASTS ECR activities going forward. While the meetup is tailored to early-career researchers, everyone is welcome to join regardless of seniority. The meetup consists of three parts.

Part A: Introduction to the DASTS ECR Working Group
We'll begin with a brief introduction to the DASTS ECR Working Group, which was established following the DASTS2024 Conference at DTU to stimulate a strong research environment for early-career researchers in the Danish STS community across and between different institutions.

Part B: Research Speed Dating
Conference programmes are full of opportunities to hear about other people's research, but rather fewer formalized opportunities to actually talk to them about it. This can be especially challenging for early-career researchers, who might not have built strong connections outside their home institutions yet. In a series of short, timed rounds, you'll pair up with another researcher, exchange accounts of your work, and then rotate. We'll provide a few conversation prompts to help get things started, but you're welcome to improvise.

Part C: The Wall of Ideas
What should the DASTS ECR Group focus on in the future? PhD courses, writing groups, methods exchanges, reading circles, publication workshops, or something we haven't thought of yet? We'll have a space for you to write down your ideas before wrapping up with a collective discussion of what's emerged and next steps.

E1

Parallel Cartographies: Mapping the Infrastructures of Knowledge on Diversity and Sustainability

Sabrina Vitting-Seerup (University of Copenhagen), **Lærke Højgaard Christiansen** (Technical University of Denmark)

In this experimental panel, we ask: What infrastructures shape what becomes "true" in domains influenced by science, activism, and industry? And do these infrastructures operate differently in fields grounded in natural versus social science? We explore these questions through a creative, participatory mapping method that surfaces the often-tacit underpinnings of two increasingly institutionalized fields: diversity and sustainability.

Over the past decades, both concepts have moved from the activist or academic margins to center-stage in public discourse, policymaking, and corporate strategies. But they have traveled via different epistemic pathways: diversity is often tied to the social sciences and identity politics, while sustainability is frequently linked to natural sciences and systems thinking. Both are deeply shaped by infrastructural forces, from media narratives, funding regimes, and institutional norms to affective atmospheres, data cultures, and ideas of evidence.

Before entering the mapping activity, participants will hear two short provocations. Højgaard Christiansen will present on how diversity mobilization in Danish institutional contexts often relies on specific legitimacy codes: quantifiable, gender-based data (especially about women), while aspects like ethnicity, neurodivergence, or lived experience remain underacknowledged, in part because they are difficult (or politically sensitive) to measure. Here, data becomes the infrastructure of visibility and legitimacy. Vitting-Seerup will present on how sustainability has successfully aligned itself with the authority of natural science, often through environmental indicators, climate models, and system metrics. Drawing on concrete cases, the talk will show how this alignment grants sustainability claims epistemic authority and policy traction, sometimes at the cost of other kinds of knowledge.

Mapping Activity
Participants will then work in small groups using a co-creative, arts-based mapping method, drawing from traditions in cartography and speculative world-building. Mapping here is treated not as

representation, but as inquiry: a way of surfacing relational, infrastructural, and epistemic dynamics.

How the experimental co-creation will work:

- Participants will split into two groups, each focusing on one field: diversity or sustainability.
- One group will draw imagined maps of the actors and infrastructures they believe shape diversity knowledge and discourse.
- The other will map those of sustainability knowledge and discourse.
- The resulting maps will then be shared and discussed in a collective reflection session, drawing parallels, contrasts, and points of friction between the two domains.

We would like to invite all interested to attend this co-creation workshop. This means that people will not be providing paper presentations, but will help draw co-created maps of the knowledge infrastructures of sustainability and/or diversity. The only requirement is for participants to share their bio and indicate which topic they would like to work on (sustainability and/or diversity) so that we can prepare proper groups for them to work in.

E2

Enlivening Data: Experimental Practices in Data Physicalization

Arshia Eghbali, **Martin Trandberg Jensen** (Aalborg University), **Anders Koed Madsen** & **David Broomham** (Technical University of Denmark)

This experimental panel explores data physicalization as a way of enlivening data, making it experiential, embodied, and sensorially present. As data increasingly shapes social, political, and private life, we ask how hybrid physical-digital practices can reimagine data not as a distant abstraction, but as something we can touch, feel, play with, and encounter.

Physical-digital data projects can be anywhere: in museums, libraries, archives, classrooms, street corners and city squares, or simply in our hands. They inform publics, educate students, provoke emotions, raise awareness, spark dialogue, and invite critical reflection. Data physicalizations are not bound to exist merely as final "outputs" that exhibit findings. They can be the process: a way of generating, collecting, and communicating knowledge. They can function as research methods, participation platforms, or immersive art experiences.

We demonstrate and examine data physicalization as a form of interactive storytelling as well as multimodal inquiry. Physical-digital installations, interactive maps, situated data experiences, participatory processes, and data sculptures expand how data can be encountered and by whom. Such projects expose the politics of data mapping, reveal hidden layers of social and everyday life, and highlight how meaning emerges in the encounter between humans, materials, and data.

Our aim is to cultivate a creative and critical space for discussing and showcasing data physicalization as an approach that combines insights from the digital humanities with those from the world of art and design.

This panel comprises diverse formats: presentations of physical-digital installations, interventionist research projects, data-oriented artworks, curatorial visions, and participatory design experiments, as well as critical essays and research papers:

- Exploring data as more than digital, distant abstractions but as situated stories, sensory experiences and material objects that we can engage with.
- Reimagining data physicalization not as a way to exhibit findings, but as an embodied "process" or research method for generating and collecting knowledge through multimodal inquiry.
- Examining relationships between bodies and data when the experience is moved out of the lab, turning data into a shared and situational encounter.
- Creating experiences and meanings through an active process that emerges during the encounter between humans, materials, and data.

E2.1. The Urban Jackpot: Circulating Urban Stories as Data Physicalization

Arshia Eghbali, Martin Trandberg Jensen (Aalborg University)**, Anders Koed Madsen & David Broomham** (Technical University of Denmark)

The Urban Jackpot is at once a research tool and a public engagement art installation. It features a lightweight, browser-based application embedded in a refurbished vintage slot machine, equipped with a digital interface. Participants pull the lever to activate a randomized pairing of photo-story cards drawn from two data sources: (1) contemporary observations of Copenhagen submitted by citizens via our Urban Belonging app; and (2) historical images from Copenhagen archives. Participants are then prompted to react to these photo-stories and leave their own voice. As a travelling installation, deployed in different locations, the Urban Jackpot is designed to circulate stories across neighborhoods and urban publics. Integrated into a broader toolchain, it completes the scaled photo-voice workflow of our urban Listening Toolkit, addressing a persistent problem: research data often remains an intangible, cloud-based artifact that participants seldom re-encounter. Urban Jackpot is a deliberately tactile exercise in data physicalization that reimagines data not as a distant abstraction but as something we can touch, feel, play with, and encounter.

E2.2. Homo Carbonicus: Enlivening Carbon Data through Improvisation Theater

Markus Wernli, Jen Yoohyun Lee, Susan Evans (The Hong Kong Polytechnic University) **& Omi-peah Ryding** (Independent Researcher, Copenhagen)

Our workshop contributes to the Enlivening Data panel by treating data physicalization as a process rather than an output: situated encounters where carbon-related data becomes touchable, enactable, and open to negotiation. The experiment with drama-based, more-than-human storytelling is a collective inquiry into the multimodal understanding of carbon transitions and their footprints. Our introductory 20-minute group improvisation draws on Bertolt Brecht's Inductive Rehearsal and Augusto Boal's Forum Theater. We begin with a simple dataset, such as atmospheric carbon dioxide, sectoral emissions, or carbon residence times. Participants are provided with situational prompts based on chemical formulas derived from these figures.

Through Inductive Rehearsal, the facilitator guides the group in improvising a short scene that materializes the biochemical processes of carbon atoms through changes in posture, proximity, movement, and scenarios. Using Forum Theater, participants then re-narrate these enacted dramas, articulating everyday human situations from the perspective of carbon atoms. Each enactment is a live data physicalization that reveals how simple embodiment changes the understanding of a systemic configuration in which carbon flows are amplified or dampened. The workshop closes with a debrief on embodied experiences of the underlying action data and nonhuman perspectives on human activities within planetary metabolism.

E3

On Using Generative AI in Research: Discussing Different Approaches

Csilla Duray (Technical University of Denmark), **Natalie Marie Gulsrud** (University of Copenhagen), **Jana Hecktor**, **Simon David Hirsbrunner** (University of Tübingen), **Anders Koed Madsen** (Technical University of Denmark)

Generative AI (GenAI) has become an everyday technology that is often positioned as a one-size-fits-all tool to solve complex problems. Parallel to its use in political, economic, and technical discourse, GenAI has also become an essential part of the infrastructures of knowledge production and academic work itself, which leads to a wide array of epistemological issues. It also invites new ways to involve stakeholders in co-creation and scenario planning, and allows for the democratization of contexts such as urban planning (Williams et al., 2024). In this panel we want to open a discussion on how GenAI is already used as an addition to existing research methods. There are good reasons why GenAI is already being used in research: inviting new voices, opening avenues for novel qualitative approaches, creating big ethnographic data, adding new perspectives and ideas, or simply using these systems as a brainstorming partner.

Yet key challenges remain around questions of engagement, context-based accuracy, and overall democracy, as well as the quality of data (Kerche et al., 2026), biases embedded in training data, and the tendency to hallucinate. Ethical considerations and critical perspectives have already been rightfully expressed. Overall, one could argue that we are currently at a polycrisis where technocratic solutions have become en vogue despite their potential problems and limitations.

We want to ask: do we really need (more) AI in our research? And in which use cases is GenAI genuinely beneficial? When is it constraining or misleading research? And is it worth all the negative dimensions, from the resources being used to the inherent technical problems? Building on workshops conducted in the contexts of technology impact assessment and planning for urban futures, this panel explores the opportunities and pitfalls of using these tools as a way to invite different stakeholders to share their expertise, both in terms of scenario design and in terms of modelling participant perspectives with LLMs. This panel discusses how the use of GenAI can elevate engagement processes and contribute to the ways in which we capture big ethnographic data.

E3.1. Generative AI and New Infrastructures of Research Writing: Uncertainty, Decision-Making and Researcher Independence

Marie Larsen Ryberg (University of Copenhagen)

'Writing is re-writing,' writing scholar Donald Murray proclaimed in 1972, establishing a position that views writing as 'a process of discovery through language' where re-writing involves re-searching, rethinking and redesigning (2003). Today, as generative AI technologies are incorporated into chatbots, search engines and writing application interfaces, the practice of writing and re-writing is becoming reliant on new, often veiled infrastructures, fostering cautions against 'stylistic and conceptual homogenization' (Sourati et al. 2026). In this paper, I examine how GenAI chatbots figure as infrastructure in research writing, shaping how research unfolds. Drawing on interviews and verbal protocols with 12 PhD students and 8 PhD supervisors within the natural and health sciences, I explore how GenAI enters into the space of uncertainty and decision-making that saturate a research process. Following the notion of 'literary inscriptions' (Latour & Woolgar, 1979), writing can be seen as a core site of research where data becomes argument, uncertainty becomes claim. Rather than merely assisting final text production, I show how GenAI infrastructures shape decision-making throughout the research process, but also create friction that raises new questions about what researcher independence might involve and re-invigorates controversies about knowledge production as disentangled or contingent.

E3.2. Relating to AI-Jesus

Christopher Gad (IT University Copenhagen)

I would like to present and discuss an experiment with interviewing an AI powered Jesus-persona as part of writing an article for a experimental special issue of the Danish anthropology journal on AI.

The experiment draws inspiration from 'methodological realism' (Bubant 2009) which allows the anthropologist to see spirits and ancestors as informants and political actors, rather than explaining away these phenomena as powerfull but unreal manifestations of something else e.g. power, culture or structures.

Knowing that AI is clearly part of a political economy, strategic exploitation etc, is it possible, fruitfull or just plain stupid to relate to AI in a similar way suspending inclinations to critique, debunking or imposing strong ontological commitments? What might we learn from interviewing AI as a quasi- or metaperson, something with an ambiguous, anthropomorphic? or spirit-like status, and from studying and taking seriously the many surprising and weird ways in which people do relate to particular forms of AI as social actors, no matter whether this is good thing or not?

E3.3. Prompting the Future: Critical Reflections on Generative AI as a Research Tool for Scenario Creation

Jana Hecktor & Simon Hirsbrunner (University of Tübingen)

Generative AI is not only the subject of intense societal and academic debate, but increasingly also a tool used within research processes themselves. Questions around transparency, regulation, and risk (e.g. privacy, copyright, bias, environmental impact) stand in tension with productive possibilities. This paper reflects on a concrete use case: the deployment of generative AI for scenario development within an interdisciplinary research project.

Drawing on first hands-on experiences of using generative AI for both creating and working with scenarios, we present initial findings and insights– including its potentials and benefits as well as challenges and problematic dimensions encountered. Precisely because the critique of generative AI is legitimate, we argue that researchers are called upon to develop a critically reflective engagement with these technologies – and to deploy them intentionally, on the basis of careful and considered weighing of positive and negative dimensions.

E3.4. Co-Creating Urban Futures with Generative AI: Participatory Design with Youth in Copenhagen

Natalie Marie Gulsrud (University of Copenhagen) **& Csilla Duray** (Technical University of Denmark)

This presentation explores how generative AI (GenAI) can be meaningfully integrated into participatory urban planning processes with young people and experts. Using Nordhavn, a rapidly changing neighbourhood, as a case study, we developed a workshop format that combines sensory site exploration with AI-supported co-creation. Following walks in the area, we invited participants to map values and use text- and image-generating AI tools to envision alternative urban futures that reflect their needs, hopes, and concerns. While often framed as a universal solution to complex societal challenges, we approach GenAI as a situated tool, one that can both expand and constrain participatory practices. We demonstrate how GenAI can lower barriers to participation by enabling non-experts to engage in design-oriented thinking and scenario-building. At the same time, we critically reflect on the limitations of these tools, including issues of bias, contextual accuracy, and the risk of decontextualised outputs. Our findings highlight the importance of careful facilitation to ensure that AI-generated content remains grounded in local knowledge and community values. Rather than positioning GenAI as a standalone solution, we argue for its use as a complementary method within participatory planning, one that requires critical engagement and methodological care.

E3.5. Using Generative AI to Bring Local Scenescapes in Early-stage Urban Design

Anders Koed Madsen (Technical University of Denmark) **& Sofie Burgos Thorsen** (INVI - Institute for Wicked Problems)

Urban design processes often begin with short site visits or selected reference locations. Epistemic practices that support a structured professional vision (Goodwin 2015) but risks overlooking micro-affordances and subcultural cues shaping everyday use of an area. This paper examines how generative AI, applied to large collections of local digital traces, can support a different mode of early design inquiry that foregrounds local scenescapes (Silver and Clark 2016). The case is a design experiment for Refshaleøen in Copenhagen developed with Henning Larsen Architects where ten years of user-generated photographs were analyzed through computational pattern detection and qualitative interpretation. This process surfaced recurring motifs, shifts in place identity, and small-scale features of urban nature and culture that fell outside formal assessments of the architects. I theorise these digital traces and computational patterns as dissonant cues that helped architects rethink what counted as the experiential legacy of Refshaleøen and how it should impact its future (Stark 2011; Madsen et al. 2024). This suggests that generative AI can function as a form of artificial communication (Esposito 2022) that expands the methodological repertoire of urban design and supports more situated and culturally attentive visions for urban futures, while also raising concerns around bias, privacy and transparency.

E3.6. Between Simulation and Encounter: Generative AI as Proxy in Research Practice

Andrew Reischling & Sarica Robyn Balsari (IDEO)

In commercial research settings, generative AI is increasingly positioned as a proxy for the people researchers study, rather than an object of study. While researchers have engaged technology to study people online (Hine, 2000; Boelstorff, 2001), technology now serves as a research participant itself. How do we account for a system that both mediates and participates in the production of insight?

This lightning talk reflects on this methodological shift. As anthropologists at a design firm, we draw on experiments that stress-test existing ethnographic methods. Central to our reflection is a distinction between simulating users and simulating behaviours. Simulating users produces flattened, decontextualised aggregates. By contrast, using AI to model patterns of interaction explores how particular conditions shape behaviour, without trying to approximate the richness of human life.

We draw on an experiment that integrated AI prototypes into live research sessions for concept testing where researchers, participants and a synthetic system converged. AI probes reactions to situations that do not yet exist, but also introduces synthetic data into the encounter, blurring the distinction between what is elicited and what is generated as probabilistic outputs. We present this tension as a case study with a live demonstration, reflecting on how generative AI introduces a form of mediation in which the system is both tool and participant.

E3.7. Making Generative AI Perspectival

Johan Irving Søltoft, Csilla Duray, Anders Kristian Munk & Brit Ross Winthereik (Technical University of Denmark)

Urban planners are increasingly turning to Generative AI (GenAI) to enhance communication with citizens and better understand their perspectives (Williams et al., 2024). Yet GenAI systems often struggle to produce contextually grounded outputs, which prompts the question: How can we develop a tool that actually represents the actual conditions in cities and citizens' perspectives when engaging with them?

Using the case of the development of the public transportation system in Winterthur, Switzerland, we invited everyday users to document their experiences in the form of annotated images in situ. Building on this data to train "perspectival models" (Underwood 2019; e.g. Søltoft et al., 2024), we reintroduced its outputs in different formats to citizens. We experimented with incorporating AI without directly exposing participants to it, instead maintaining an analogue workshop format centered on dialogue and reflection.

The study aims to find new ways of giving voice to perspectives that are divergent and often excluded, simplified, or muted in bureaucratic processes. But our approach also raises ethical questions, such as: Is it possible to create a tool that is both successful at conveying citizens' experiences and ideas, and useful for planning urban environments using Generative AI? And how can we ensure that such tools engage the public rather than bypass them?

E4

Infrastructures for Ethnographic Analysis: An Experiment in Collaboration

Astrid Oberborbeck Andersen & Trine My Thygaard-Nielsen (Aalborg University)

This panel offers the opportunity to engage in "on the spot" collaborative analysis. It does so to explore and make apparent the analytical infrastructures through which ethnographers encounter, produce, and stabilize analysis. Taking the conference theme "encountering infrastructures" as a methodological provocation, we turn attention to the often backgrounded conceptual and empirical arrangements that make ethnographic analysis possible. Rather than treating analysis as a stage that follows fieldwork, the panel foregrounds analysis as an infrastructural accomplishment: ongoing, relational, and collaborative.

We approach ethnographic analysis as work that is built, maintained, and sometimes unsettled through heterogeneous infrastructures, such as data material (fieldnotes, recordings, transcripts, archives, photos, and artefacts) as well as conceptual infrastructures such as analytic vocabularies, sensitizing concepts, theoretical traditions, and disciplinary conventions. Together, these infrastructures shape what can be noticed and made meaningful.

The panel is explicitly experimental in form and ambition. Contributions engage analytically and reflexively with moments when infrastructures for analysis become visible, through breakdowns, frictions, methodological doubt, or deliberate experimentation. How do ethnographers encounter their own analytical infrastructures? How do particular infrastructures enable certain analytical moves while constraining others? What happens when analytical infrastructures are shared, collectively negotiated, tinkered with, or temporarily suspended?

Conceived as an experiment in collaborative analysis, the panel aims to create a collective space for thinking with and through the ethnographic materials brought and shared by each participant. These materials can take the form of field notes, vignettes, elaborated pieces of ethnography, or ethnographic materials in multimodal formats such as photographs, video, sound, drawings, artefacts, or others. The session will take form as a workshop where each participant presents the material and its ethnographic context (the situation and project in which it has emerged) as well as a theoretical darling, understood as a concept, approach or theory that the ethnographer imagines can inform the analysis. We will workshop and think the materials through each other in a layered fashion, and connect these with the theoretical darlings. What can we learn about analytical infrastructures in ethnography when we let our materials and theoretical favourites meet and challenge one another? Altogether, the panel seeks to move beyond individualized accounts of research and instead explore analysis as a distributed and infrastructural practice.

E4.1. Encountering Analytical Infrastructures in Courtroom Ethnography: Feminist Legal Mobilization in Omani Family Courts

Sumaiya AlWahaibi (University of Copenhagen)

This contribution reflects on the analytical infrastructures through which courtroom ethnography becomes meaningful in the study of women's legal mobilization in Oman. The material presented consists of fieldnotes from family court sessions in several Omani cities, documenting interactions between litigants, judges, mediators, and court officials in cases involving divorce, custody, alimony, and inheritance. These observations capture moments where legal reasoning, religious references, and social expectations intersect in the everyday practice of adjudication.

The theoretical "darling" guiding the analysis is feminist legal mobilization, which examines how women engage legal institutions to negotiate rights within gendered social structures. While this framework highlights women's strategic use of law, the ethnographic material also reveals tensions between formal doctrine, judicial discretion, and prevailing social norms.

The analytical challenge explored in this workshop concerns how different infrastructures, fieldnotes, courtroom narratives, legal categories, and feminist theoretical vocabularies, shape what becomes visible as women's agency within legal processes. By bringing these materials into a collaborative analytical setting, the contribution asks how ethnographic infrastructures enable particular interpretations of legal practice while constraining others.

E4.2. Terms and Conditions Apply: Negotiating Access to Commercial and Proprietary Infrastructures

Miriam El-Mahdi (University of Copenhagen)

How may negotiation of fieldwork access to corporate actors become a way of exploring and co-constructing infrastructure? While approaching tech start-ups and multinational pharmaceutical companies involved in building, maintaining and utilizing cross-border data infrastructures, I have learned to understand the negotiation of terms and conditions as integral to the topic itself. I initially set out to study the practices through which health data is made mobile and valuable. However, gaining access to these actors proved difficult and required prolonged negotiations shaped by concerns around data privacy, commercial sensitivity, and non-disclosure.

These negotiations did not simply precede the research but became part of it. The researcher, together with companies and their gatekeepers, constructed the tempo-spatial space in which fieldwork could take place through choices, restrictions and negotiations. This enabled proximity to some elements of the infrastructure while rendering others inaccessible or opaque and shaped what could be observed, what could be recorded, and what could be retained as data. Just as data infrastructures have been to be as much about what they hide as what they show, my negotiations of access came to explore which parts of the infrastructure that are kept out of scrutiny and which are showcased. Here, I reflect on the methodological and analytical tensions brought forward by this fragmented and constrained encounter with infrastructures.

E4.3. Thin Surprises: Experiment, Simplicity, and Anthropological Analysis

Frederik Vejlin (Aarhus University)

My contribution will, hopefully, emerge from fieldwork at GVLab, a robotics laboratory at the University of Tokyo, which I am currently carrying out as part of the project "Experimental Surprise: Pursuing Unex-pectedness in Scientific and Artistic Practices." My material will centre on human-robot interaction experiments, most likely an experiment in which participants walk blindfolded while guided by the robot Pepper. I will be back from fieldwork before DASTS, bringing material from these experimental settings in the form of fieldnotes, vignettes, transcripts, or whatever else makes sense.

Analytically, I am interested in how thinness and simplicity might complicate anthropological analysis. If anthropology is often drawn toward thickness, complexity, and contextual expansion, what surprises might the thin and the simple occasion instead? Drawing on Dan-Cohen's (2019) elaboration of Riles' (2000) notion of “thin composition,” I am keen to explore what becomes possible when ethnographic material is allowed to be superficial, selective, and formally restrained.

This also entails taking experimentation seriously as a practice that makes phenomena amenable to study through abstraction, rearrangement, and simplification. Thus, I hope to discuss how experimental simplifications and ethnographic analysis can challenge one another, and how novel analytical infrastructures might become visible when simplicity is treated as a condition for certain kinds of generative surprises.

E4.4. Making PFAS Data: Climate-Exacerbated Chemicals and Environmental Knowledge in Denmark

Tim Schütz (University of California)

This presentation focuses on how per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) become environmental data objects and infrastructures in Denmark, especially as climate change exacerbates PFAS risks. Also known as "forever chemicals," PFAS are among the most persistent pollutants, yet recent research shows that rising temperatures, extreme rainfall, flooding, drought, and strong winds accelerate their mobility and expand exposure pathways. I thus approach PFAS as a climate-exacerbated chemical hazard whose combinatory and cumulative risks challenge environmental governance regimes. I also argue that PFAS data becomes integrated with intersecting climate risks in ways that reconfigure place-making (Knox 2024). The presentation builds on preliminary research with PFAS scientists in California and outlines plans for ethnographic fieldwork among Danish researchers and enterprises developing PFAS data and knowledge infrastructures. Amid growing detection of PFAS in ocean sea spray and coastal foam, I focus in particular on how these infrastructures are situated within and mobilized by coastal communities. Methodologically, the project develops a digital archive hosted on the Platform for Collaborative and Experimental Ethnography (PECE), which functions as an open research workspace for curating timelines, organizational profiles, and data visualizations. These materials are designed to elicit reflection on emerging PFAS–climate data double binds and knowledge gaps.

E5

Platform Imagination: Artistic Practices, Alternative Tech, and Feminist STS Encounters with Digital Infrastructures

Freja Kir Kirchheiner (Royal Danish Academy)

Digital platforms have become infrastructural conditions of contemporary life, shaping how we communicate, learn, work, and imagine. Yet their operations remain opaque, hidden behind seamless interfaces and corporate narratives of efficiency and innovation. This panel proposes platform imagination as a methodological and analytical framework for encountering digital infrastructures otherwise, through artistic practice, feminist STS, and feminist technoscience.

Bringing together researchers and practitioners across media studies, art, design, and STS, the panel explores how artistic and alternative technological initiatives function as epistemic sites for learning, rehearsing, and reimagining dominant platform logics. Artworks, workshops, community servers, and experimental design formats are approached as methodological interventions that render infrastructural relations perceptible and open to negotiation. In line with the conference theme Encountering Infrastructures, the panel foregrounds artistic practices as ways of engaging infrastructures as situated, affective, and relational environments. Through case studies ranging from spatial artworks to collective learning formats and experimental infrastructures, we examine how digital systems are encountered through metaphor, embodiment, speculation, and care. These encounters do not simply represent infrastructures; they actively shape how they are sensed, understood, and potentially transformed.

Recent media and social theory has identified multiple forms of technological imaginaries, including algorithmic (Bucher, 2017), cryptographic (West, 2018), and platform imaginaries (Gillespie, 2010; Van Es & Poell, 2020). At the same time, Ruha Benjamin (2023) argues that technological determinism and capitalist innovation logics have narrowed collective capacities to imagine otherwise, replacing imagination with solutionist "innovation" that overlooks digital inequalities. Imagination thus becomes a site of struggle, where alternative technological futures can be articulated through care, refusal, and creative practice.

Building on this perspective, platform imagination names how platforms are collectively imagined, sensed, and negotiated. It concerns not only what platforms are, but how their infrastructures become thinkable through metaphors, narratives, interfaces, and artistic interventions. Allegories such as the dark forest theory of the internet (Strickler, 2019; Konior, 2020) and the dead internet theory show how vernacular accounts render vast infrastructures graspable while simultaneously obscuring their material and political conditions. The panel positions artistic and alternative tech practices as key sites for questioning and reconfiguring digital interaction.

E5.1. Imaginaries of Information: Exploring Speculative Ways of Navigating Information When Transitioning to Living with ICDs.

Mai Hartmann (IT University of Copenhagen)

Healthcare systems are complex infrastructures, a tangled web of information, relations and affects, which can be difficult and disheartening to navigate for patients and next of kin. Throughout life, most people will encounter the more complicated areas of healthcare systems, where chronic and/or life-threatening conditions are treated. These encounters can be intensely affective and transformative, involving life-changing treatments and technologies. In this panel, I will relay results of my research, exploring the impact of acquiring a cardiac condition and a subsequent implantable cardioverter defibrillator (ICD) – both for the patient and their closest next of kin. My approach involves artistic methods, using watercolours in both empirical documentation, processing, analysis, ideation and design. Working with the materiality of watercolours as a generative metaphor, I explore speculative manners of engaging with data, information and emotions in the process of transitioning to life with an ICD. I will present findings from an interview study with ICD patients and partners, touching on the overwhelming encounters with informational infrastructures at precarious and often traumatic times, examples of arts-informed processing and analysis and preliminary imaginaries of alternative platforms and interactions with information.

E5.2. Knowledge Infrastructures of Search: Exploring Epistemic Power through a Bespoke Chatbot 'Rodeo'

Renée Ridgway (Aarhus University)

The actors of search are changing with the uptake of generative artificial intelligence aka chatbots, which provide one answer to all queries instead of ten hyperlinks or an overview. Generative AI marks 'an ontological rupture', altering the measures of 'fact, integrity, fidelity, provenance and interpretability' (Shah 2024), providing answers without historical and cultural contexts (Sharma 2020) and eliminating navigational media (hyperlinks) and user agency of clicking (Ridgway, forthcoming). Yet what kinds of knowledge are produced by these generative AI infrastructures of search?

This paper addresses how epistemic norms and search practices are changing with synthetic data production on a dynamic web. The interdisciplinary research investigates generative AI by surfacing answers with the same prompt from a bespoke 'chatbot rodeo,' (Gemini, ChatGPT, Llama, Le Chat, DeepSeek, Apertus, Perplexity), facilitating a comparative interface of responses co-designed with artist/programmer Anders Visti (https://re-search.site).These results reflect diversity: the agenda of the company's model, the ethics of open source public data (Apertus) or the citational with hyperlinking the live web (Perplexity). By visualising, comparing and analysing results, the paper's contribution to Feminist STS and (A)STS demonstrates how context, verifiability and legitimacy affect the production of knowledge in search infrastructures, whilst promoting (human) expertise.

E6

Collaborative Timelining as Reflexive Infrastructure: Artefacts of Danish Digitalization

Ask Greve Johansen (IT University of Copenhagen), **Laura Kocksch** (Aalborg University) **& Mark Staun Poulsen** (IT University of Copenhagen)

This experimental panel invites thinking and doing timelines of digitalization by means of writing in a public wiki: a lived archive, remaining accessible and editable after the conference. More than a shared knowledge base, we hope for this infrastructure to serve as a tool for exploring and thinking about temporalities of digitalization.

Timelines are infrastructures for experiencing, interpreting and enacting history. They may order events, suggest causality, and render actors and moments visible at the expense of others. Studying the digital past we encounter a host of timelines across genres and formats, and in retelling that past we may create our own linear temporal structures. Each timeline performs an agential cut, deciding what counts as eventful and what does not, and precludes the telling of time as other-than-linear. But they are cool sometimes, and may evoke strong affectual responses: curiosity, puzzlement, despair. Timelines, for better or worse, offer a heuristic for investigating the processes of how we come to inhabit digital infrastructures.

This panel explores timelining as both object of inquiry and method of knowledge production. We propose a deliberately multiple and collaborative approach: a shared wiki where competing temporalities, scales, and standpoints can hopefully coexist and link to one another. We envision the wiki to focus on digitalization in private and public sectors, geographically anchored in the Danish realm. A prototype wiki was tested in December 2025 in DTU's Echolab, and a sanitized version of that will be merged into a public wiki and form our starting point.

The digital artifacts and policies we timeline are themselves infrastructures of social life. But the timeline is also an infrastructure that shapes how digitalization is narrated, remembered, and contested. By building a collaborative and deliberately heterogeneous wiki, we aim for a vigilant kind of infrastructuring: attending to what gets included, what gets linked, and being curious about what remains peripheral or on the outside.


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